

- Who is responsible and for what.
- The arrangements for developing safe systems of work.
- The arrangements for reviewing and updating the policy as necessary.



Policy requirements

- To be written by someone within the organisation – those who know the organisation best and how it operates, rather than someone from outside. If companies cannot write the policy in house, it is common to seek external assistance and advice but, essentially, the policy should be appropriate to the specific needs of the business.
- It must reflect the organisation's values, beliefs and commitment to providing a safe and healthy environment.
- Companies must consult their workforce when developing the policy. As well as benefiting from workers' day-to-day experience of the job, consultation increases the likelihood that the workforce will commit to carrying out the policy's aims.
- It must be signed and dated by the person with ultimate responsibility for health and safety (for example, the owner or a managing director). Most importantly, you should make sure your actions, and those of your workers, mirror the statements you have made.
- The policy should be periodically reviewed, updated as necessary, and re-signed and dated.

A copy of a company's health and safety policy is often requested when companies are tendering for work, and when they want to get onto approved supply chain lists. For a sole trader or very small firm, all health and safety duties are likely to be the responsibility of one person.

It is important to remember that once this information is written down, if there is a serious accident, it will be used in court, either by the HSE or lawyers in a civil claim. This means people need to be aware of their responsibilities.

Appendix B contains a suggested layout of a health and safety policy for a medium-sized company carrying out small building works. Not all of it will be relevant to some companies and, conversely, it may not contain specific content that some companies require.

- For most companies, the general statement of health and safety policy should fit onto one side of A4 paper.
- The organisation and arrangements sections will be longer depending on the size of the company and the type of work that is carried out.
- Overall, the final document should be a clear indication to clients, employees and other interested parties (such as the HSE) that the company is honestly, openly and totally committed to the proper and effective management of all aspects of health, safety and welfare.



For guidance on the preparation of health and safety policy documents visit the HSE website.

4.5.2 Planning for implementation

Effective planning is essential for the implementation of health and safety management systems.

Adequate control of the risks to the organisation can only be achieved through effective **communication, co-operation** and **co-ordinated action** by all members of the organisation.

Effective planning is concerned with prevention of accidents and ill health through identifying and controlling risks. This is especially important when dealing with health risks that may only become apparent after a long period of time.

In addition to setting your policy, planning should include steps to ensure legal compliance and procedures for dealing with emergency situations. It should involve people throughout the organisation.

Basic principles for consideration in effective policy development and planning are outlined below.

4.5.2.1 Competence

When developing plans and policies, consider the level of competence necessary to comply with the law.

4.5.2.2 Directors, leaders and managers

Make a statement of intention. Say what you will do to keep a safe and healthy environment for your workers and anyone else who could be affected by your work activities.

Clearly set out everyone's roles and responsibilities and highlight those with particular roles (for example, directors, supervisors and managers, safety representatives, workers, fire wardens, first aiders and the competent person).

Say how things will be done and what resources will be allocated to make things happen.

Include details of the systems and procedures that will be in place to help to meet your legal obligations (see *overleaf*).

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- How risk assessments will be carried out.
- Plans for staff and worker training and safe use of equipment.
- Controls to ensure specifiers and buyers are competent in assessing the risks in procurement (for example, that they know the requirements for purchasing suitable personal protective equipment).
- Plans and procedures for accident and incident investigation.
- Plans and methods for consulting with workers.
- Procedures for equipment and plant maintenance.

Consider how you will measure health and safety performance. Will there be achievable targets (such as reductions in accidents or absences, or increases in reporting issues or near misses)?

Think about management of contractors when developing a policy, if this is relevant to your work.

Identify when you will revisit your policy and plans, for example, in the following circumstances.

- When changes have been made to work methods or processes.
- When changes to staffing have taken place.
- Following accident or incident investigations, both within the organisation and where lessons have been learned from others.
- Following consultation with employees' representatives.
- If you receive new information (for example, from regulators (HSE), manufacturers or others in the same sector or industry).
- After discussing safety arrangements with other occupants not employed or managed by you, but who share the same premises.

4.5.2.3 Worker consultation and involvement

Discuss your plans with workers or their representatives and communicate the plan so that everyone knows what is required.

4.6 Do (Delivering)

Delivery depends on an effective management system to ensure the health and safety of all employees and other people affected by the organisation's work.

Organisations should aim to protect people by introducing management systems and practices that ensure risks are dealt with sensibly, responsibly and proportionately.

4.6.1 Profiling your organisation's health and safety risks

Effective leaders and line managers should know the risks their organisations face on a daily and longer-term basis. They should rank these risks in order of importance and take effective action to control them.

- Assess the risks, identify what could cause harm in the workplace, who it could harm and how, and what you will do to manage the risk.
- Decide what the priorities are and identify the biggest risks.

The range of risks goes beyond health and safety risks to include quality, environmental and asset damage risks. Issues in one area could have an impact in another. For example, unsafe forklift truck driving may create service or quality problems as a result of damage to goods and materials.

A **risk profile** examines the nature and levels of threats faced by an organisation. It examines the likelihood of adverse effects occurring, the level of disruption, the costs associated with each type of risk and the effectiveness of the control measures in place.

The basic foundations of a risk profile should cover the following.

- The nature and level of the risks faced by your organisation.
- The likelihood of adverse effects occurring and the level of disruption.
- The costs associated with each type of risk.
- The effectiveness of the controls that are in place to manage those risks.

4.6.1.1 Assessing the risks

In some organisations and industries (such as construction), the health and safety risks will be tangible, immediately recognisable safety issues (for example, work at height, confined spaces, plant and machinery) whereas in other industries the risks may be health-related and it may be a long time before an illness becomes apparent.

Poorly maintained plant and degrading plant integrity could also lead to later-emerging risks.



Health and safety risks range from things that happen infrequently but with catastrophic effects (high-hazard, low-frequency events, such as an oil refinery explosion) to things that happen much more frequently but with less severe consequences (low-hazard, high-frequency events). Clearly, the high-hazard, low-frequency example could destroy the business and would be high-priority in a risk profile.

A risk assessment should be completed by someone with knowledge of the activity, process or material that is being assessed. Workers and their safety representatives are a valuable source of information.

If an adviser or consultant assists in completing the risk assessment, managers and workers should still be involved. Risk assessments should consider all your activities, taking account of possible harm to the following people.

- Employees.
- Contractors.
- Members of the public.
- Those using products and services.
- Anyone else affected by the activity (such as neighbours).



For detailed information on risk assessments refer to Chapter A05 Risk assessments, method statements and permits to work.

4.6.1.2 Effective risk profiling

Effective risk profiling should involve members of the whole workforce, as a broad knowledge of the entire organisation will be needed to draw up its risk profile. In high-hazard organisations, establish what specialist advice may be necessary to identify hazards and analyse risks. Make sure workers are trained and have information about risk controls. Identify who takes ownership of risks. This person might be the owner or chief executive; in larger organisations there may be a risk committee or a senior board champion for health and safety.



**What may be the consequences of the worst possible occurrence for your organisation?
How confident are you that plans are in place to control the effects?**

Maintain an overview of the risk-profiling process and make sure you are aware of the major risks within your organisation. Check that minor risks have not been given too much priority and that major risks have not been overlooked. Identify who is responsible for implementing controls and over what timescale. Make sure you consider the following points.

- Assess the effects of changing technology.
- Think about issues related to changes in asset ownership. These may increase the risk if design information and knowledge isn't passed on.
- Plant and equipment will deteriorate with age, so you may need to change inspection regimes to reflect this.
- Think about everyone who might be affected by your work activities.
- Remember that certain groups may be at increased risk (for example, young or inexperienced workers, pregnant workers, workers with a disability, migrant workers or aging workers).

4.6.1.3 Control measures, reporting and consultation

Control measures. Consider whether any control measures are already in place or if further action is needed. Recognise that full implementation of control measures may take time, and implement interim measures to minimise the risks.

Report, record and review. Report risk control performance regularly. Make sure any paperwork generated is kept to the minimum level necessary, to avoid overload or miscommunication. Review the organisation's risk profile regularly. Change within the organisation can affect the risk profile (for example, during economic cycles such as recession and recovery, when there is an increase in workload, or when experience levels drop).

Worker consultation and involvement. Consult with workers and their representatives in all parts of the organisation to ensure that all areas of risk have been identified.



**Do workers understand the organisation's risk profile and their responsibilities?
Do they have the necessary information, instruction and training to deal with the risks that have been identified?**

4.6.2 Organising for health and safety

Organising for health and safety is the collective label given to activities in four key areas that together promote positive health and safety outcomes. This section of the management system should clearly show the specific arrangements that a company has put in place to manage health and safety across its normal work activities.

Controls within the organisation – the role of managers and supervisors: leadership, management, supervision, performance standards, instruction, motivation, accountability, rewards and sanctions.

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Co-operation between workers, their representatives and managers through active consultation and involvement.

Communication across the whole organisation, through visible behaviours, written material and face-to-face discussion.

Competence of individuals through recruitment, selection, training, coaching, specialist advice and avoiding complacency. Capability training helps people gain the skills, knowledge and, ultimately, the competence to carry out their work safely and without risk to their health. You may also need to engage specialist help if your business has hazardous or complex processes.

Some of the site-wide elements that might need to be addressed with control, co-operation, communication and competence are shown below.

Site activities	Administration procedures
- Hot works. - Production of dust or fumes. - Noise and vibration. - Work at height. - Confined space entry. - Protection of the public. - Authorisation for the use of plant and equipment. - Lone working. - Machine guarding. - Loading and unloading. - Lifting equipment and lifting operations.	- Emergency procedures. - First aid. - Fire. - Means of escape. - Accident reporting. - Welfare facilities. - Employee consultation. - Monitoring for the effectiveness of health and safety procedures. - Health surveillance. - Driving at work/use of company vehicles. - Young persons.

4.6.2.1 Controls within the organisation – the role of managers and supervisors



Anyone engaging contractors has health and safety responsibilities both for the contractors and for anyone else who could be affected by their activities.

Due to their regular contact with workers, managers and supervisors can make an important contribution to risk control by:

- making sure everyone knows how to work safely and without risk to their health, and
- making sure all workers follow the organisation's rules.

Managers' and supervisors' roles and responsibilities should be clearly defined.

Managers and supervisors should be suitably trained and competent in carrying out their roles, recognising the importance of supervision as a part of active risk control. The supervisor or team leader should have sufficient resources to deal with health and safety issues as part of getting the job done. Ask yourself: does everybody know their specific responsibilities and roles with regard to maintaining safe places of work?



Responsibilities

Who is responsible for the following roles?

- Developing and implementing safe systems of work.
- Consultation with the workforce and worker engagement.
- Issuing instructions on how work is to be carried out safely.
- Supervising or managing day-to-day health and safety issues.
- Making sure that everyone is competent to do what is required of them.
- Developing risk assessments and method statements that include the persons responsible for managing each risk.
- Carrying out periodic health and safety inspections.
- Dealing with maintenance matters.
- Measuring health and safety performance and reviewing or updating procedures as necessary.
- Ensuring that sub-contractors have a satisfactory health and safety management system and follow safe working practices on site.

4.6.2.2 Co-operation – Consultation and engagement with employees

An essential part of health and safety management is the two-way communication process between employers (or their representatives) and employees. There are legal duties on both parties with the intent that communication takes place in both directions. Employers and their managers must talk to, and listen to, the people who actually do the work.

The **Safety Representatives and Safety Committees Regulations 1977** and the **Health and Safety (Consultation with Employees) Regulations 1996** (refer to Chapter A01 Health and safety law) outline the requirements of the employer to consult with employees. **CDM** (refer to Chapter A03) also have a requirement for consultation with workers.

To gain co-operation, **worker involvement** is essential. This means involving the workforce beyond the legal minimum requirements and in more than a basic consultation. Such an approach can help develop a genuine management and workforce partnership, based on mutual trust, respect and co-operation, where problems can be jointly explored and solved and workers' thoughts and ideas freely shared, valued and acted upon.

Beyond the required legal minimum standard, worker involvement means the full participation of the workforce in the management of health and safety.

At its most effective, full involvement creates a culture where relationships between employers and employees are based on collaboration, trust and joint problem solving. Employees are involved in assessing workplace risks and in the development and review of workplace health and safety policies in partnership with the employer.



For guidance on leadership and worker engagement refer to Chapter A09.

4.6.2.3 Communication

Employers are legally required to bring their health and safety policy and management system, and any subsequent revisions, to the notice of all employees. CDM emphasise the need for consultation and engagement with workers. Communicating the health and safety policy is a good way of achieving this.

Often the reality of workplace conditions and the practices that have developed escape the notice of senior management. This may be because pressures, techniques, environments and expectations change over time.

The only way to find out if the requirements of the policy and management system are realistic and workable is to talk to the people who have to comply with them in the workplace.

Think about what needs to be communicated and to whom. How will your health and safety policy, risk assessment findings and safe systems of work be shared? Sufficient time should be allocated for communications to take place.

Consider the arrangements for receiving and distributing information and formulate plans that explain how information will be distributed and communicated throughout the organisation.

Plans should consider and identify how you will communicate effectively with the following people.

- Employees.
- Contractors.
- Anyone with low levels of literacy.
- Workers whose first language is not English.

Delegation of health and safety duties and procedures for safety-critical tasks should also be clearly communicated.

Suitable arrangements for enabling anyone to report suspected or actual failings in health and safety management to someone in authority must be in place. These arrangements must be communicated to workers along with the reassurance that their concerns will be listened to and feedback provided.

Emergency procedures for first aid, fire, and the reporting and recording of near misses, incidents, accidents and dangerous occurrences will also need to be communicated, and confirmation given by recipients that they have clearly understood the information.



For detailed information on methods of communication refer to Chapter A08 Behavioural safety.



Larger sites

The system of communication on larger sites (where there may be many companies on site and several tiers of sub-contractor) must allow for the health and safety concerns of individuals to be considered by someone with the authority to rectify the situation.

- The person on the tools and their supervisor might be more aware than others on site of an unsafe situation developing at the workplace.
- All workers should have clear lines of communication and the opportunity to feed any health, safety or welfare concerns directly to a site-based manager or supervisor who has the authority to take the appropriate action.

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4.6.2.4 Competence

Under health and safety law, employers must appoint one or more competent persons to help carry out the measures needed to comply with the law. It is important for organisations to decide the level of competence necessary to comply with the law. The preference would be for the nominated person to be someone from within the organisation who has the appropriate skills, knowledge and training, together with experience of the business.

In deciding who to appoint to the role, a judgement can be made using the organisation's risk profile. The role could be allocated to the owner or to someone else in the organisation who does not necessarily have a qualification but does have knowledge and experience of the business.



The nominated person should be able to recognise issues outside their competence, so that more experienced advice can be sought where necessary.

Where relevant expertise is not present within the organisation, companies may choose to procure the services of suitable consultants and advisers.

4.6.3 Training

HSWA requires that employers provide all necessary information, instruction, supervision and training to enable their workforce to carry out their tasks safely and without risks to their health.

The law also requires that you make sure workers understand the information, instruction and training you are giving them, taking account of any language difficulties or disabilities. You may need to provide information in a language other than English.

Consider workers' individual capability before allocating work. Will they have the capacity to react safely to changing circumstances? If they are unable to do so, what might the consequences be?



Questions that should be asked

- Is there provision for training now, and for the future?
- Who identifies the gaps between *skills needed* and *skills held*, and establishes the training needs of individuals?
- Who is responsible for making sure training is carried out?

Training may take many forms, in addition to conventional training room sessions. For example:

- site inductions
- toolbox talks
- safety leaflets, books and informational posters explaining the company's health and safety policy and procedures
- on-the-job training and instruction on plant, tools or equipment, explaining risk assessments and method statements.

Procedures should be in place to:

- track the type of training given and who has received it
- assess the training and provide feedback that the training was appropriate and has been understood; and, if not,
- make arrangements for additional training.



For detailed information on competence and training refer to Chapter A06 Induction and training.

4.6.4 Appointing and managing contractors

Anyone engaging contractors has health and safety responsibilities, both for the contractors and for anyone else who could be affected by their activities. Contractors themselves also have legal health and safety responsibilities. Make sure everyone understands the part they need to play in ensuring health and safety.



Use of contractors in itself does not result in poor health and safety standards, but poor management can lead to injuries, ill health, additional costs and delays.

Working closely with the contractor will reduce the risks to your own employees and the contractors themselves. Contractors may be at particular risk; they may be strangers to your workplace and therefore unfamiliar with your organisation's procedures, rules, hazards and risks. Even regular contractors may need reminding. The level of control needed will be proportionate to the complexity of the task.

On sites with major accident hazards, consider shut downs, turnarounds and span of control over the contractor – given the potentially high numbers of contractors on site (compared with the numbers in routine operations).

When contractors are engaged, the contract documents should clearly explain the work you expect the contractor to do and the standards of competence that will be required. Demonstrate the importance your organisation places on health and safety in the selection of safe contractors, and ensure you allocate sufficient time and resources to the task – in planning, preparing and carrying it out. Suitable arrangements for monitoring and supervision should be allocated to ensure shortcuts are not taken to reduce costs and that there is no conflict of performance versus safety. Directors should support management decisions to stop work if there are serious health and safety concerns raised about contractors' actions or performance, and they should be ready to address health and safety failings by engaging directly with the leader of the contracting organisation. Similarly, directors should acknowledge any successes. Contingencies and procedures should be in place if things don't go to plan.



Further details of the requirements for assessing and appointing contractors can be found in the **third-party contractor assessment in Appendix A, and in Chapter A03 Construction (Design and Management) Regulations 2015.**



Visit the HSE website for *Using contractors: A brief guide (INDG368).*

4.6.5 Implementing your plan

4.6.5.1 Risk control plans

Leaders should take positive steps to address issues arising from human factors and to encourage safe behaviour. They will need to recognise that the prevailing health and safety culture is a major influence in shaping people's safety-related behaviour. The necessary resources should be made available to successfully implement the plan. Resources include the following.

- Human resources and specialised skills.
- Organisational infrastructure.
- Technology.
- Financial resources.

To effectively implement workplace precautions, the risk control systems and management arrangements should be designed to recognise the existing risks, practices, human capabilities and limitations present within the organisation. It will then be possible to decide on the preventative and protective measures needed and put them in place.

- Provide the right tools and equipment to do the job, and keep them maintained.
- Provide training and instruction to ensure everyone is competent to carry out their work.
- Provide supervision, to make sure that arrangements are followed.

The control of **relatively minor risks** affecting all employees (such as ensuring passages and gangways remain free from obstruction) can be dealt with by a number of simply stated general site rules and housekeeping procedures.

The control of **more hazardous activities** may require the use of more detailed risk control systems.

The control of **high-hazard activities** may demand detailed workplace precautions and a risk control system that needs to be strictly followed (such as a permit-to-work system).

Maintenance activities can introduce additional risks. The type, frequency and depth of maintenance activities should reflect the extent and nature of the hazards and risks revealed by a risk assessment.

The balance of resources devoted to the various risk control systems will also reflect your risk profile.

4.6.5.2 Documentation

Any risk control documentation produced should be **functional** and **concise**, with the emphasis on its effectiveness rather than on a sheer volume of paperwork.



Focusing too much on the formal documentation of a health and safety management system will distract from addressing the human elements of its implementation – the focus becomes the process of the system itself, rather than actually controlling risks.

4.6.5.3 Principles for effective implementation

- Responsibilities and accountabilities should be clearly defined, communicated and understood by all involved in the process.
- Realistic timescales for meeting objectives should be clearly agreed with the workforce.
- Documentation should be proportionate to the complexity of the risks concerned. Keep it to the minimum needed for effectiveness and efficiency.
- Demonstrate your commitment to delivery at all levels within the organisation, through visible behaviour and by using a variety of communication channels to engage your workforce (for example, written material and face-to-face discussions).
- Keep people informed of progress and maintain a focus on the main risks and issues.

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- Use review meetings (or make use of existing internal forums) as a basis for identifying further improvements.
- Measure progress of implementation against clear milestones or performance indicators and make adjustments if there is early evidence that requirements are not being met.
- Recognise contributions and safe behaviours that help to create or reinforce positive attitudes and behaviours.
- Monitor arrangements to give you the assurance that workers and contractors are following workplace precautions and risk controls.
- Involve and consult workers and representatives throughout any implementation.
- Ensure you have systems in place that allow workers to raise concerns and make suggestions (for example, staff suggestion schemes, online communities, safety forums or committees, and so on).
- Make sure you consider all feedback, take action and provide prompt responses to concerns or questions raised.

4.7 Check (Measuring performance)

Checking that you are managing risks in your organisation is a vital, sometimes overlooked step. Taking this step, however, will give organisations the confidence that you are keeping on top of health and safety. It may also identify improvements for the future. Organisations need to make sure plans are implemented and risks are being controlled.

Checking involves setting up an effective monitoring system, backed up by sensible performance measures and, in some circumstances, by formal audits.



4.7.1 Types of monitoring

There are many different types of monitoring but they can generally be categorised as either **active** or **reactive**.

- Active monitoring methods monitor the design, development, installation and operation of management arrangements. These tend to be preventative in nature, as follows.
 - Routine inspections of premises, plant and equipment by staff.
 - Health surveillance to prevent harm to health.
 - Planned function check regimes for important pieces of plant.
- Reactive monitoring methods monitor evidence of poor health and safety practice but can also identify better practices that may be transferred to other parts of a business. For example:
 - investigating accidents and incidents
 - monitoring cases of ill health and sickness absence records.

Most organisations use performance measures as part of their monitoring. Checking performance against a range of predetermined measures is one of the most frequently used monitoring techniques. Selecting the right measures to use is critical. Using the wrong measures will cause unnecessary and unproductive effort, with little benefit for the organisation.



For detailed information on measuring performance refer to Chapter A10 Inspections and audits.

4.7.2 Investigating accidents and incidents

In any organisation, things don't always go to plan. You need to prepare to deal with unexpected events in order to reduce their consequences. Workers and managers will be more competent in dealing with the effects of an accident or emergency if there are effective and regularly tested plans in place.

Investigating and analysing incidents will also make a big contribution to understanding health and safety in your business. You should monitor and review any measures that are in place to help control risk and prevent accidents and incidents from happening. Findings from investigations can form the basis of the following actions.

- Preventing the accident or incident from happening again.
- Improving overall risk management.
- Pointing to areas of risk assessment that need to be reviewed.

An effective investigation requires a methodical, structured approach to information gathering, collation and analysis. Investigation findings will also provide essential information that may be required in the event of a civil claim, or HSE enforcements or prosecutions.



For detailed information on investigation refer to Chapter A13 Accident reporting and investigation.

4.8 Act (Reviewing and learning lessons)

Reviewing health and safety performance is an important part of business and the process of continual improvement in health and safety management. It will help organisations establish whether their health and safety principles are embedded as a natural part of day-to-day operations.

A health and safety performance review will tell you if your systems are effective in protecting your people.



4.8.1 Reviewing performance

Carrying out reviews will confirm whether the organisation's current health and safety arrangements still make sense. A review also does the following.

- Enables the company to check the validity of its health and safety policy and ensure that the systems in place for managing health and safety are effective.
- Identifies how the health and safety environment in the business has changed.
- Enables leaders to highlight and to stop doing things that are no longer necessary, while allowing the business to respond to new risks.
- Gives the opportunity to celebrate and promote health and safety successes.

Increasingly, third parties are requiring partner organisations to report health and safety performance publicly.

The most important aspect of reviewing is that it closes the loop. The outcomes of a review become the next steps in the plan for health and safety.

4.8.2 Learning lessons

Learning lessons involves acting on the findings of accident investigations and near-miss reports and resolving organisational vulnerabilities identified during monitoring, audit and review processes.

As is common with management arrangements, it is an ongoing challenge to ensure that all health and safety requirements are complied with consistently. All too often, many organisations find out after an accident or case of ill health that they already had systems, rules, procedures or instructions that would have prevented the event but which were not known about, considered or complied with.

The underlying causes often lie in arrangements which have been designed without taking proper account of human factors, or where inappropriate actions are condoned implicitly or explicitly by management action or neglect.



For detailed information on audits and reviews refer to Chapter A10 Inspections and audits.

4.8.3 Updating management systems and policies

The law requires that employers revise their management systems and policies as often as may be appropriate. This means they should be updated in light of any new legislation, HSE or industry guidance and British or European Standards, as well as take into account actual experience in using the policy on a day-to-day basis (for example, by evaluating whether the policy is effective).

Changes in the type of work carried out, changes in staff and changes made as a result of any accidents or incidents will also give rise to the need for a policy review. In addition, the policy should be regularly reviewed to ensure that it stays relevant to the company's overall operations.



It is recommended that the policy is reviewed annually, with the policy being re-signed, dated and any changes communicated to the workforce. Even if there are no required changes, it should still be re-signed and dated in order for the company to demonstrate a review has taken place. This is important for companies that have to provide copies of their policy for a third-party assessment scheme or to prospective clients.

Appendix A – Third-party contractor assessment

Being able to prove health and safety competence in the construction industry is a crucial element to securing contracts. Clients will always seek highly competent principal contractors who then, in turn, will look for the same in the sub-contractors that they employ.

CDM state that both contractors and sub-contractors must be able to demonstrate the necessary skills, knowledge, training and experience to fulfil their role.

There are many different ways that this is achieved; a common method is through a pre-qualification questionnaire, where health and safety documentation is submitted for review and assessment. The information includes, amongst other things, the requirements for contractors to have a health and safety policy, to have access to competent health and safety advice and to ensure that employees are appropriately trained.

Assessing health and safety competence can be a complicated and time-consuming process. There are two levels that need to be considered.

Stage 1 – The primary level. This is the ability of an organisation to prove that their arrangements for managing health and safety are sufficient to allow them to carry out work safely and without risk to the health of their workers.

Stage 2 – The second level assesses competence in relation to experience and the needs of the particular job. It looks at an individual's track record of working on similar types of project to those being tendered for.

Several schemes have been developed to help clients and contractors alike to meet their obligation to only appoint competent contractors.

The schemes are a pre-qualification assessment designed around the requirements of CDM. Competence is assessed against the criteria set out in Stage 1 including, amongst others, the requirements for contractors to have a health and safety policy, access to competent health and safety advice and to ensure employees are appropriately trained.

By satisfying the scheme assessment, the contractor is able to demonstrate Stage 1 competence to future employers, avoiding the need to repeat the process for every client or contractor worked for. This also helps those buying services from contractors, as they need only worry about Stage 2 type assessments (for example, matching the experience of the contractor to the work being undertaken).

Safety schemes in procurement

Safety schemes in procurement (SSIP) was founded in May 2009 following a government report called *Accelerating the SME economic engine: through transparent, simple and strategic procurement*. Supported by the HSE, SSIP aims to streamline pre-qualification and encourage straightforward mutual recognition between its member schemes.

The aim of SSIP is to actively reduce health and safety assessment costs and bureaucracy in the supply chain by standardising the contents of requested information and through accreditation of a single scheme. This should make cross-recognition between member schemes as effective as possible, and highlight the savings to buyers and suppliers. Bodies such as the Contractors Health and Safety Assessment Scheme (CHAS), Constructionline, Exor and the National House-building Council (NHBC) are SSIP members.

SSIP forum founder members agreed and signed up to achieve the following.

- Act as an umbrella organisation to facilitate mutual recognition between health and safety pre-qualification schemes wherever it is practicable to do so.
- Actively advise and influence clients about acceptable interpretation and appropriateness of health and safety competence standards in UK schemes.
- Embrace the core guidance on skills, knowledge, training and experience of CDM.



SSIP forum members are committed to avoiding duplication within pre-qualification. If contractors have already been assessed by another SSIP member they can apply for registration for another SSIP recognised scheme, usually by downloading and completing the 'Deem to satisfy' application form.



More information about the scheme can be found on the SSIP website.

Contractors Health and Safety Assessment Scheme

The Contractors Health and Safety Assessment Scheme (CHAS) is a pre-qualification scheme, widely used to identify companies that have demonstrated, through the CHAS assessment process, that they have a robust approach to health and safety management.

CHAS assesses applicants in the following areas.

- Health and safety policy statements.
- The health and safety arrangements of their organisation.
- Their specific health and safety arrangements to a standard acceptable to buyers and others.

The scheme is a private limited company owned by the London Borough of Merton and concentrates on what it refers to as *fundamental health and safety management and compliance issues* related to the type of work the applicant has indicated they do.

 **More information about the scheme can be found on the CHAS website.**

Constructionline

Constructionline is the Government's national register and is the UK's largest register for pre-qualified contractors and consultants. It is a public-private partnership between Capita and the Department for Business, Innovation and Skills. Like CHAS, Constructionline provides a pre-qualification tool for use in financial standing, technical references and other areas. The CHAS management group supports the principles of a single register and so works jointly with Constructionline.

CHAS and Constructionline have formed a mutual working agreement. This sets out how they will work together to provide an improved service for the industry's clients. CHAS and Constructionline are independent bodies but their databases are linked. It is therefore possible that not having an acceptable health and safety policy could be detrimental to company assessment by Constructionline.

 **More information about the scheme can be found on the Constructionline website.**

Safecontractor

Safecontractor is a health and safety assessment scheme with more than 350 major clients and over 27,000 contractor members.

Registered members with the Safecontractor scheme include clients and contractors from a wide range of professional disciplines working within a number of industry sectors. The Safecontractor scheme is now used by many large organisations as a way of obtaining competent contractors.

 **More information about the scheme can be found on the Safecontractor website.**

Safemark

Safemark is the health and safety competence assessment scheme of NHBC. It is the only scheme designed by house-building specialists for house builders. It is recognised bySSIP.

 **More information about the scheme can be found on the NHBC website.**

HEALTH AND SAFETY MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS – APPENDIX B

Appendix B – Example of a health and safety policy



Example health and safety policy

Health and Safety
Executive

Example policy for an alarm installation company

Setting the scene

Daly Response Alarm Systems supply and install intruder alarms to residential and business premises. Manager and founder John Daly employs a total of 22 staff, consisting of an assistant manager, a receptionist, three customer service support advisers, four sales representatives, two accounts assistants, a head engineer and ten site engineers.

The office is open Monday to Friday 9.00-5.30 and Saturday morning 9.00-12.00 and cleaning is shared by the office-based staff, who have a rota.

John Daly prepared his own health and safety policy statement, using the combined template available on the HSE website at www.hse.gov.uk/simple-health-safety/policy/policy-statement-template.pdf. He genuinely cares for his staff and wants to portray this in his health and safety policy.

John downloaded the template and referred to the example policy statement and other guidance available on the HSE website at www.hse.gov.uk/risk/. This helped him to think about the things that should be documented and built into his own health and safety policy, such as remote working, personal protective equipment, staff consultation and training etc. He decided that he and his assistant manager would be the most competent (experienced and capable) people to take responsibility for health and safety issues.

John presented the policy statement at the staff meeting and decided to review and update the document every year or straightaway if there are any major changes in the workplace.

Employers with less than five employees don't have to write down their health and safety policy. For further information and to view our example risk assessments, see www.hse.gov.uk/risk/. Example health and safety policy published by the Health and Safety Executive 08/14



Example health and safety policy

Health and Safety
Executive

This is the statement of general policy and arrangements for:			Daly Response Alarm Systems
John Daly – Manager			has overall and final responsibility for health and safety
Paul Phillips – Assistant Manager			has day-to-day responsibility for ensuring this policy is put into practice
Statement of general policy	Responsibility of: Name/Title	Action/Arrangements (What are you going to do?)	
Prevent accidents and cases of work-related ill health by managing the health and safety risks in the workplace	John Daly Manager	Relevant risk assessments completed and actions arising out of those assessments implemented. (Risk assessments reviewed when working habits or conditions change.)	
Provide clear instructions and information, and adequate training, to ensure employees are competent to do their work	Paul Phillips Assistant Manager	Staff and subcontractors given necessary health and safety induction and provided with appropriate training (including working at height, asbestos awareness and electrical safety) and personal protective equipment. We will ensure that suitable arrangements are in place to cover employees engaged in work remote from the main company site.	
Engage and consult with employees on day-to-day health and safety conditions	John Daly (Manager) Paul Phillips (Assistant Manager) All staff	Staff routinely consulted on health and safety matters as they arise but also formally consulted at regular health and safety performance review meetings or sooner if required.	
Implement emergency procedures – evacuation in case of fire or other significant incident. You can find help with your fire risk assessment at: https://www.gov.uk/workplace-fire-safety-your-responsibilities	John Daly Manager	Escape routes well signed and kept clear at all times. Evacuation plans are tested from time to time and updated as necessary.	
Maintain safe and healthy working conditions, provide and maintain plant, equipment and machinery, and ensure safe storage/use of substances	Paul Phillips Assistant Manager	Toilets, washing facilities and drinking water provided. System in place for routine inspections and testing of equipment and machinery and for ensuring that action is promptly taken to address any defects.	
Signed: * (Employer)	J Daly	Date:	21st December 2024

You should review your policy if you think it might no longer be valid, eg if circumstances change. If you have fewer than five employees, you don't have to write down your policy.

Health and safety law poster is displayed at (location)	Reception
First-aid box is located:	Staff room
Accident book is located:	Reception

Accidents and ill health at work reported under RIDDOR (Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations) <http://www.hse.gov.uk/riddor>

(Dates updated by CITB)

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Risk assessments, method statements and permits to work



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GT700 Toolbox talks/supporting guidance documents

Toolbox talks on some of these topics are available in the GT700 publication. Supporting guidance documents covering some of these topics are available on our companion website.



Scan the QR code to complete a brief survey, and share your feedback on the course.

RISK ASSESSMENTS, METHOD STATEMENTS AND PERMITS TO WORK

Overview

The assessment of risk is the fundamental principle behind the drive for a reduction of workplace accidents and work-related ill health.

Risk assessments and method statements (RAMS) need to be suitable and proportionate to the risks, specific to the site, tasks and activities, and fully understood and appreciated by the workforce.

Assessing risk is not a difficult process, but many companies rely on generic risk assessments and method statements that bear little resemblance to how their workers actually carry out the work.

5.1 Introduction

The principle of risk assessment is fundamental to the management of health and safety in the workplace. Legislation places a legal duty on employers to assess the risks, to the health and safety of their employees and others, that arise out of their work.

There is also a requirement in other sets of regulations for employers to carry out risk assessments in relation to specific threats to health or safety in the workplace, such as those shown below.

- The use of hazardous substances.
- Noise.
- Manual handling.
- The presence of asbestos.
- Work at height.
- Work with vibrating tools and equipment.

However, this does not put an obligation on employers to carry out two risk assessments for the same hazard.

If the general risk assessment covers the specified hazards, that risk assessment alone will be sufficient.



Risk assessment

There is no legal definition of a risk assessment, but in practice it is a careful and structured examination of a work activity so as to identify:

- what could cause harm (the hazards) to people (employees or others)
- how, by the use of appropriate control measures, the risks (the chance that the hazard will cause harm) arising from the hazards may be eliminated or controlled.

The amount of effort that needs to be put into carrying out a risk assessment should be appropriate and proportional to the nature of the hazard and the perceived level of risk.



It is essential that all high risks are assessed and controlled first, before looking at the medium risks. Only look at the low risks once all high and medium risks have been either eliminated or adequately controlled.

Simple work activities with few hazards, which present a low risk, should need only simple assessments. If a risk assessment is to be effective, it is essential that the person who carries it out is competent in all aspects of the task that is being assessed.



Risk assessment is not about creating huge amounts of paperwork – it is about identifying sensible measures to control the risks in your workplace.

Risk assessments do not necessarily need to be carried out by a health and safety professional. When the task being assessed is often repeated or is otherwise familiar, simple or routine, managers and supervisors will often be sufficiently skilled, knowledgeable and have the training and experience to carry out a risk assessment.

However, where a task presents complex, unusual or technical issues it may be necessary to seek the advice of a competent person, or to seek advice from other sources, such as the Health and Safety Executive (HSE) or a relevant trade organisation.

Digitisation of risk assessments should be considered, as investing in technology gives a business the competitive edge over others. It will aid collaboration, as it gives a business the tools to get everyone involved in the process.

It will also enhance and improve health and safety, as it ensures that everyone is involved.

5.2 Important points

- The assessment of risk is the fundamental principle behind the drive for a reduction of workplace accidents and work-related ill health.
- Employers with five or more employees are required by law to record the significant findings of their risk assessments.
- Main (or principal) contractors may wish to see written risk assessments from any contractor they intend to employ, regardless of the number of employees.
- Risk assessments must consider the potential risks to the health and/or safety of anyone who may be adversely affected, which may include employees, the employees of other contractors, site visitors, members of the public, and so on.
- Carrying out risk assessments need not be difficult or unduly time-consuming; the effort should be proportionate to the degree of perceived risk.
- There is no official content or way of structuring a risk assessment; it is for each employer to decide what works best for their organisation.
- It is vital that written risk assessments, method statements and permits to work are presented in an easy to understand format for those that are actually doing the work.
- Method statements are a way of integrating the information gained during the risk assessment process into a structured sequence of work for completing a job.
- Permit to work systems are often used to regulate how activities with the potential to be high risk can be carried out in a healthy and safe manner (for example, entry into a confined space or hot works). As such, they support the risk assessment from which they are derived.

5.3 Terms used in risk assessment

Anyone carrying out risk assessments must be familiar with the meaning of the following terms that are used in the process.

Hazard: anything that has the potential to cause harm (ill health, injury or damage).

Risk: the likelihood of an event occurring from a hazard coupled with the severity of harm.

Likelihood: the chance (probability) that an accident will occur (certain, likely, possible, unlikely or rare).

Severity: the severity (consequences) of any incident that arises.

Danger: a person is in danger when they are exposed to a risk.

Accident: an unplanned event that results in damage, injury or ill health.

Near miss: (including dangerous occurrence) an event that, while not causing harm, has the potential to cause injury or ill health.

Competence: having practical and theoretical knowledge, training and actual experience of the work involved.

e.g. Severity

- At one extreme, someone who is buried in a collapsed excavation could be killed, whereas, at the other end of the scale, the consequences of someone not using a hand tool correctly might only be grazed skin or a cut.
- When assessing risk to health, severity can be misunderstood or underestimated. Someone breathing in silica dust for a day or two will not seemingly be harmed, but continual exposure over many months or years could lead to a fatal lung disease.

5.4 Legislative requirements

5.4.1 Principles of risk assessment

All recent health and safety legislation is structured around a goal-setting or risk-based approach to managing health and safety in the workplace. Employers are required to establish systems that identify hazards, assess the associated risks, develop and implement suitable control measures, and monitor the adequacy and effectiveness of such risk control systems. Employer responsibilities are shown below.

Identify the hazards (things with the potential to cause harm) that arise out of the work activity being assessed.

Assess the risks to the health and safety of any person(s) who is likely to be affected by the hazards.

Identify the individuals or groups of people who are at risk.

Eliminate the hazards (where possible) thereby removing the risk of injury.

Identify and implement appropriate measures to control the remaining risks.

Effectively monitor and review control measures for the work activity and amend them if they are no longer valid or become ineffective.

RISK ASSESSMENTS, METHOD STATEMENTS AND PERMITS TO WORK

5.4.2 Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999

The regulations require employers to carry out a suitable and sufficient assessment of the risks to health and safety for all work activities.

When carrying out risk assessments, employers must consider not only the wellbeing of their own employees but also anyone else who may be affected by that work activity.

This includes, but is not restricted to, the following.

- The employees of other contractors or the self-employed.
- Site visitors (such as delivery drivers).
- Members of the public, including children.
- The client, customers or other occupiers of the property.

Particular provision is made in the regulations for the protection of young persons in the workplace.

Although not mentioned in the regulations, it is implicit that any risk assessment must, where appropriate, take into account the requirements of anyone on site who may suffer from a disability (for example, someone who is partially or totally deaf).

The duty to undertake risk assessments is placed on all employers irrespective of the number of persons they employ but, where five or more persons are employed, the significant findings of the assessment must be recorded (either in writing or electronically).

However, clients may, if they choose, require contractors to produce recorded risk assessments even when fewer than five persons are employed by them. The self-employed have a similar duty to undertake risk assessments for the work that they do, to identify the risks to the health and safety of both themselves and others who may be affected by the work that they carry out.

Once the risk assessment has been carried out, employers must then implement the control measures that are necessary to protect those at risk. It is then important to ensure that the significant findings of the risk assessment are made known to all persons who are likely to be involved in the work or be affected by it.

In order to understand the principles of risk assessment, it is necessary to first understand the meaning of the terms used, as defined by the HSE in its publication *Risk assessment: A brief guide to controlling risks in the workplace*.



A **hazard** is anything with the **potential** to cause harm. Examples are electricity, noise, vibration, chemicals, asbestos, working at height, working over water, excavations, confined spaces, manual handling, falling materials, and the use of tools, plant and vehicles.

A **risk** is the **likelihood** that the **hazard** will actually cause harm.



Risks of working at height

If working from a ladder the likelihood of the person falling (the risk) could be regarded as high when compared with doing the same job from a scaffold platform fitted with guard-rails. A control measure (the scaffold) has been introduced and so the likelihood of a fall occurring is significantly reduced.

The regulations require that all risk assessments are **suitable** and **sufficient**. For a risk assessment to comply with this requirement it must achieve the following.

- Establish the risks arising from the work activity.
- Be appropriate, given the nature of the work, such that it remains valid for a reasonable period of time.
- Be proportionate to the level of risk and the nature of the work.
- Identify and prioritise the control measures required to protect the health and safety of the employees and others who may be affected.

Furthermore, to be suitable and sufficient each risk assessment must take account of any factors that could change during the course of the job, thereby introducing additional hazards or increasing the level of risk arising from existing hazards.

Examples of this are variable labour levels, being asked at short notice to do something a different way to accommodate others, and work or hired equipment having to be returned if the job overruns.

The law does not expect you to eliminate all risk, but you are required to protect people as far as is reasonably practicable.

5.4.3 Young persons and children

Regulation 19 of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations contains specific provisions in respect of the health and safety of children and young persons.

Employers are required to specifically assess and review the risks to the health and safety of children and young persons on construction sites due to their lack of maturity, experience or knowledge of potential risks.

Young persons and children

A **young person** is anyone under the age of 18.

A **child** is anyone who has not yet reached the official minimum school-leaving age. Pupils reach the minimum school-leaving age in the school year in which they turn 16.

Children under 13 years cannot be employed at all. At the age of 13 they can work part time, with restrictions, and can start full-time work (40 hours per week) when they reach the minimum school leaving age.

If someone starts work at the age of 16 they are paid through PAYE. At the age of 18 adult employment rights and rules apply.

Children between 13 and the minimum school leaving age may, in accordance with local byelaws, with the permission of the Local Authority and after significant risks have been explained to the parents or carers, attend a construction site for site visits and organised work experience.

If a child is employed on work experience the employers' liability insurance policy will cover the work placement, as long as the insurer is a member of the Association of British Insurers or Lloyds.

Furthermore, there will be occasions when 14- to 16-year-old children are on site under an apprenticeship training scheme. If children will be doing or observing work on a construction site the employer must consider the risk involved and they must be satisfied that the instruction, training and supervisory arrangements have been properly thought through and work in practice.

Where children are employed either for work experience or work in offices then the employer must, before commencing the employment of the child, provide that child's parents or guardians with details of any risk assessment that has been carried out. This information must contain details of any risk and a description of any preventative or protective measures, whether the risk arises from the employer's own activity or the work of others at the workplace.

Before a young person or child is employed, the employer must ensure that any risk assessments relating to the job take account of the following factors in relation to the young person.

- Their inexperience.
- Their immaturity and lack of awareness of risks.
- The tools and equipment that they may have to use as part of their training.
- The layout of the workplace and the environment in which they may have to work.
- Any hazardous substances with which they may come into contact.
- Exposure to physical, chemical or biological hazards.
- The organisation of work and work processes.
- The extent of health and safety training that is to be provided.

Careful consideration must be given to the way in which information is conveyed to young persons to ensure that it is fully and readily understood.

Employers are further required to consider the special nature of young persons due to their lack of experience, reduced knowledge of risks and the fact that they are not fully mature. To that end, young people must not be employed in any of the following work.

- That which they cannot physically or psychologically cope with.
- That which exposes them to a range of hazardous substances, including any carcinogen, toxic substance or radiation.
- Where they might not recognise the risk of accidents due to their inexperience or lack of training.
- Where their health would be at risk from excessive cold, heat, noise or vibration.

The prohibition above does not apply when a young person is undergoing recognised training, or when they are being properly supervised by a competent person, or when any risks identified in a risk assessment have been reduced to the lowest level that is reasonably practicable.

For the training provision to apply, the training must be necessary within a trade or occupation, and be part of an identified unit of NVQ, SVQ or other similar work-related qualification.



A young apprentice receiving training on site

 For further information on employing young people and children visit the HSE website.

RISK ASSESSMENTS, METHOD STATEMENTS AND PERMITS TO WORK



Builder sentenced after young worker seriously injured

Magistrates ordered a builder from Cornwall to pay out nearly £10,000 after an employee sustained serious, life-changing hand injuries whilst operating a hand-held circular saw. Bodmin Magistrates' Court heard how the building services company was refurbishing a barn in Callington. A young worker, who had just turned 17, was using a circular saw to cut wooden flooring sheets when the blade made contact with his hand. It severed his index finger, cut three quarters of the way through his middle finger and half way through his ring finger.

An investigation by the HSE found that the builder had no record of any information, instruction or training that he had provided to his employee in the safe use of the circular saw, and nor had he ensured that safe working practices were followed when the employee was cutting the flooring sheet. The investigation also found that, at the time of the incident, the circular saw blade had not been properly adjusted for the size of material being cut and that the flooring sheet was not appropriately supported while being cut.

The accused builder pleaded guilty to breaching Section 2(1) of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974 and Regulation 3(4) of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999. He was fined £1,120 and ordered to pay costs of £8,489.48. A HSE inspector said after the hearing: 'This injury was easily preventable and the risk associated with the task should have been identified. Employers should make sure they properly assess and apply effective control measures to minimise the risk of contact with dangerous parts of machinery to ensure that the risks are given careful attention to ensure they are properly controlled.'

05

5.4.4 Expectant and nursing mothers

In accordance with regulations 16-18 of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations, once an employee has notified her employer in writing that she is a new or expectant mother, employers have certain obligations towards the employee, where the nature of the work may put the mother or unborn child at risk.

When an employee provides written notification to her employer stating that she is pregnant, or that she has given birth within the past six months or that she is breastfeeding, the employer should immediately take into account any risks identified in their workplace risk assessment.

The assessment may identify the need to temporarily alter the work environment, work pattern, work activity or working hours and provide additional facilities or support.

If this is not possible, the employee should be offered suitable alternative work (at the same rate of pay). If this is not available or feasible then the employee will need to be suspended from work on paid leave for as long as necessary in order to protect her child's health and safety.

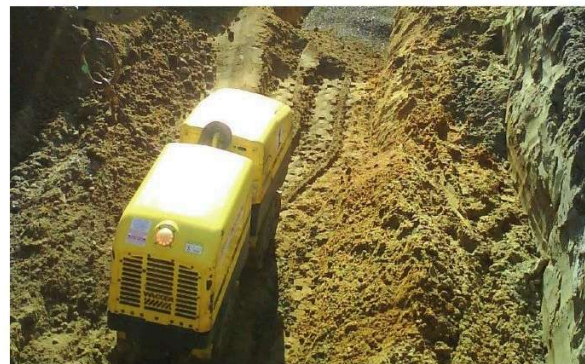


For further information refer to *Guidance for new and expectant mothers at work*, available from the HSE website.

5.5 General principles of prevention

Preventative and **protective** (control measures) must be taken to address the hazards and to eliminate or reduce the risks to an acceptable level. These measures must be based upon the general principles of prevention, which are listed in Schedule 1 of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999 as follows.

- Avoiding risks where possible.
- Evaluating risks that cannot be avoided.
- Combating risks at source.
- Adapting the work of an individual, especially regarding the:
 - design of the workplace
 - choice of work equipment
 - choice of working and production methods.
- Adapting to technical progress.
- Replacing the dangerous with the safe or less dangerous.
- Developing a coherent prevention policy that covers:
 - technology
 - working conditions
 - organisation of work
 - social relationships.
- Giving collective measures priority over measures that protect the individual.
- Giving appropriate instructions to employees.



Using a remote controlled trench compactor eliminated the need for a person to be in the excavation

5.6 Steps to risk assessment

The HSE has a step-by-step process for controlling health and safety risks caused by hazards in the workplace. The steps needed to manage risk are as follows.

Step 1. Identify the hazards.

Step 2. Assess the risks.

Step 3. Control the risks.

Step 4. Record your significant findings.

Step 5. Review the controls.

5.6.1 Step 1. Identify the hazards

Some typical examples of hazards found on construction sites are shown below.

- An untidy site with lots of slipping and tripping hazards.
- The use of equipment with rotating blades (like disc cutters).
- The use of power tools creating dust.
- The risk of fire from spark-emitting tools (like angle grinders).
- Manual handling work or working in cramped conditions.
- Work at height with the potential for falls (such as roofing work).
- The operation of construction plant near to people on foot.
- The presence of contaminated ground.
- The use of chemicals, solvents, paints, and so on.
- What safe or unsafe work practices exist.

5.6.2 Step 2. Assess the risks

Having established the hazards, identify the individuals or groups of people who could be harmed and how serious it could be, such as those shown below.

- Yourself.
- Other employees (particularly the young and inexperienced).
- Employees who need special consideration (for example, someone who is deaf or who is not fluent in English).
- Employees who are pregnant, or nursing mothers.
- Employees of other contractors.
- Visitors (such as delivery drivers, maintenance staff and clients).
- Members of the public or trespassers (particularly children).
- Anyone else who might be affected by your work (for example, neighbouring businesses).

5.6.3 Step 3. Control the risks

Having identified the hazards, now consider what risk-control measures are necessary to ensure the health and safety of the people who have been identified as being at risk.

Consider if a hazard can be removed altogether. If not, consider how to control the risks so that harm is unlikely, for example by: redesigning the job; replacing material, machinery or process; organising and planning work to reduce exposure; identifying and implementing practical measures for safe working; or, as a last resort, providing personal protective equipment and ensuring that it is worn.

Even when control measures have been put in place there will usually be a remaining (residual) risk. You will have to exercise your judgement as to whether, in your opinion, the residual risk is high, medium or low.



Ask yourself: What have I done to control the risks and what more do I need to do?



Considerations when establishing controls

When establishing appropriate control measures, consideration should be given to the following techniques.

Combat risks at source – for example, use a safer method (such as using a block splitter instead of a petrol cut-off saw).

Take advantage of technical progress and adopt new, safer methods of working – for example, use a modern trestle system, complete with guard-rails and toe-boards.

Replace the dangerous with the non-dangerous or less dangerous – for example, prohibit the use of all 230-volt power tools, allowing only battery-powered or 110-volt tools.

Adopt measures that protect the greatest number of individuals – for example, safety nets protect everyone working above them, whereas a safety harness only protects the wearer.

Give appropriate information, instructions and training to employees and others – assess the need for training.

Provide personal protective equipment – always the very last resort.

RISK ASSESSMENTS, METHOD STATEMENTS AND PERMITS TO WORK

5.6.4 Step 4. Record your significant findings

Health and safety law requires that all employers carry out risk assessments for their work, although legally only employers with five or more employees need to record the significant findings of their risk assessments. However, in practice, many of the larger contractors will not accept any sub-contractor on site, even those with fewer than five employees, if they do not have written risk assessments. Risk assessments may be recorded electronically providing that they can be easily retrieved for scrutiny if required.

In the interests of clarity, risk assessments may identify where relevant supporting information can be found (such as the company health and safety policy), rather than including masses of information in the risk assessment itself. However, if this approach is taken, the supporting documents may also have to be supplied to whoever needs to refer to the risk assessment. The law does not specify how risk should be measured but three common methods have evolved over time.

Qualitative risk assessment – outlines hazards present and risk control measures needed; no attempt is made to quantify the level of risk.

Semi-quantitative risk assessment – the process is the same but the level of risk is quantified by categorising it as high, medium or low, to enable corrective actions to be prioritised.

Quantitative risk assessment – numerical scores rather than a grade are assigned to the likelihood and severity of the risk.

Examples of these approaches to risk assessment are included later in this chapter (*refer to 5.7*).



What to identify in a risk assessment

Irrespective of how a risk assessment is laid out, it is considered good practice for it to identify the following.

- Person(s) who will manage the residual risks.
- Review date.
- Date(s) by which any essential actions must be taken, in the interests of health or safety.

5.6.5 Step 5. Review the controls

Risk assessments should be reviewed from time to time to ensure the control measures are still appropriate and effective. If there is a change to any aspect of the way the job has to be carried out that might affect health and safety (for example, having to use a different item of equipment part way through the job, the arrival of a new operative who is inexperienced, unexpected deteriorating weather or the late arrival of materials) the assessment must be reviewed and the risks re-evaluated.



The HSE has produced *A brief guide to controlling risks in the workplace*.

5.7 Types of risk assessment

The risk of something going wrong is considered in terms of likelihood (probability) and severity (consequences).

5.7.1 Generic risk assessments

- A generic risk assessment is an assessment that may be used more than once because the job to which it relates is being repeated and it can be guaranteed that the hazards and level of risk are the same on each occasion that the job is carried out.
- When an employer intends to rely on a generic risk assessment, great care must be taken to ensure that there are no factors that could introduce additional hazards or increase the level of risk.
- In many cases, generic risk assessments are not acceptable within the construction industry because each site is different and conditions change as construction work progresses.

5.7.2 HSE risk assessments (Qualitative)

The HSE has produced a simple qualitative template that does not use ratings, but instead uses the headings listed below. Some prefer this method as it follows logical risk assessment steps. It can also be easier for the workforce to understand.

What are the hazards?	Who might be harmed and how?	What are you already doing?	Do you need to do anything else to control the risk?	Action by whom?	Action by when?	Done



The HSE has made this free-to-download template available in Word format and produced a series of example risk assessments, which can be found on its website.

5.7.3 Semi-quantitative assessments

The **likelihood** of a hazard actually causing harm or an accident is rated as being high, medium or low in accordance with the following.

High: it will happen regularly, or it could be a usual or a common occurrence.

Medium: it is less regular, but is still recognised as being likely to happen.

Low: it has not happened for a long time, is known to be infrequent and is not likely to happen.

The **severity** of the event, should it happen, can then be categorised as follows.

High: the result could be a fatal accident or multiple injuries, major property damage, substantial pollution or environmental impact.

Medium: it would probably cause serious injuries (or persons would be off work for over seven days due to their injuries), substantial property damage or there may be some pollution.

Low: there would be minor injuries to persons or some slight damage to property.

Probability and consequences can then be shown on a matrix as follows.

Likelihood	High			
	Medium			
	Low			
		Low	Medium	High
		Severity		

Probability and consequences can then be assessed and the highest outcome of the two entered in the matrix as follows.

Likelihood	High	High	High	High
	Medium	Medium	Medium	High
	Low	Low	Medium	High
		Low	Medium	High
		Severity		

- A combined risk of **high** should be totally unacceptable and the work should not be undertaken until the risk has been reduced.
- When there is a combined risk of **medium**, action must be taken and work stopped if necessary to reduce the risk level.
- If the combined risk is **low**, start the work as long as everything reasonably practicable has been done in order to reduce the risk, and review the assessment at regular intervals.

Using this information, decisions can now be made on whether an activity is safe to continue, or whether control measures are necessary, either to completely change the way that the job is done or to put measures in place to bring the risks down to an acceptable level. In the ideal situation, both probability and consequences should be **low**.

5.7.4 Quantitative assessments

These are generally used for higher-risk situations or environments. The principle is the same as for semi-quantitative assessments, but numerical scores are assigned to likelihood (probability) and severity, generally rated on a scale of one to five, as shown below.

- 5 **Certain** to happen.
- 4 **Very likely** to happen, and would not be at all unusual.
- 3 **Likely** to happen, and would not be totally unexpected.
- 2 **Unlikely** to happen, but not by any means impossible.
- 1 **Very unlikely** to happen.

The severity (consequences) of the event, should it happen, are also then rated using the same scale, as shown below.

- 1 No injury, ill health or damage. It would be a near miss.
- 2 Minor injury or minor ill health complaint, no time lost. Minor property damage or minor environmental incident.
- 3 Lost time injury, up to and including reportable injury to the HSE with over seven days' time lost, but not a specified injury. Some risk of immediate or long-term health issues. Significant property damage or local environmental damage.
- 4 Specified injury, long-term absence or significant risk that could lead to immediate or long-term health illness, including reportable disease. Substantial property damage and/or serious environmental impact.
- 5 Fatal accident or multiple specified injuries. Catastrophic event or environmental disaster. Public or others could be involved as well.

RISK ASSESSMENTS, METHOD STATEMENTS AND PERMITS TO WORK

A matrix can then be constructed using these numbers, as follows.

Likelihood	5					
	4					
	3					
	2					
	1					
		1	2	3	4	5
		Severity				

All possible resulting numbers are calculated by multiplying all the likelihood figures by all the severity figures. These are included in the matrix, as shown below. This means that once a risk assessment has been made on a particular activity, and the likelihood factor is multiplied by the severity factor, the number produced indicates where the assessment places the risk associated with the activity on the matrix.

Likelihood	5	5	10	15	20	25
	4	4	8	12	16	20
	3	3	6	9	12	15
	2	2	4	6	8	10
	1	1	2	3	4	5
		1	2	3	4	5
		Severity				

Risk rating	Colour	Risk description
Above 15		Totally unacceptable and the work will not be undertaken until the risk has been significantly reduced.
Between 9 and 14		Immediate action must be taken, including a stoppage of work, if necessary, to reduce the risk level to acceptable.
Between 5 and 8		Acceptable, provided that everything reasonably practicable has been done to reduce the risk.
4 or less		Acceptable, provided that the assessment is reviewed at regular intervals and further reduced if possible.

Clearly, the higher the resulting number the less acceptable the level of risk. The matrix shows where actions need to be taken to reduce either the likelihood or the severity in order to reduce the risks to an acceptable level. Employers can use these numbers to set in-house criteria, if desired, along the following lines, and as indicated by the shaded areas in the above matrix.



It is for individual companies or managers to decide where the boundaries between what is and what is not acceptable lie, and the numerical score at which certain actions should be taken. The above matrix is only an indication of what can be done.

If either the qualitative or semi-quantitative methods are used in conjunction with a simple form, then the employer will have a straightforward, basic risk assessment procedure.



The HSE research report *RR151 - Good practice and pitfalls in risk assessment* can be found on its website.

5.8 Risk assessment in practice

If the task to be assessed is substantial, difficult or complex then, in all probability, it will not be practical or effective to carry out a single risk assessment to cover the whole of the work. The job will need to be broken down into separate elements or work, each of which will have to be assessed separately. Alternatively, it should be possible to cover the whole of a relatively straightforward job (such as re-tiling the roof of a house) with a single risk assessment. The process of practical risk assessment has no fixed rules for how it should be undertaken, or how risk assessments should be structured or laid out. Each company will decide upon what suits its needs.

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The process for developing risk assessments should not be over-complicated. The simpler the process, the less likely that anything will be overlooked. It may need input from both management and employees, and should address the points below.

- What is going to be done? This should include plant, equipment, people, materials and the working environment.
- How exactly is the activity to be carried out (for example, what plant and competences are required)?
- Where and when is the work to be done?
- How could this work affect employees and other people?
- What risk control measures are already in place?
- Is the level of risk to health or safety acceptable?
- What additional risk control measures are necessary?

The above approach to the identification of all relevant hazards associated with the work will address the following.

- The likelihood of injury or harm arising to employees and others who may be affected by the work.
- Any other specific legal requirements.
- All of the risks.
- The necessary control measures to eliminate or reduce health and safety risks associated with the work, based on the hierarchy of preventative and protective measures.
- The information needed for those involved or affected by the work.

5.8.1 Actions for employers

Once you have created a risk assessment, you will need to do the following.

- Put into effect the measures that you have decided will adequately control the risks.
- Communicate the findings of your risk assessments, particularly details of the hazards identified and what control measures are in place, to anyone who needs to know (for example, the main (or principal) contractor, your employees and sub-contractors).



It is extremely important that the findings of risk assessments are communicated to anyone whose health and/or safety is likely to be affected by the job.

5.8.2 Actions for supervisors

Once you have received the risk assessment, you will need to do the following.

- Speak to the site manager on a regular basis.
- Check that the risk control measures to be put in place are right for the work situation.
- Seek clarification of uncertainties and make your manager aware of any findings of a point of work risk assessment so that control measures are corrected and recorded.
- Before briefing your work team ensure the risk assessments and method statements are correct for the site specifics.
- Explain the risk assessments and method statements to your work team, ensure understanding (by asking questions) and record the names of those briefed (and when).

5.9 Communication



Those people physically carrying out the task should be consulted in the assessment process as they can have valuable knowledge and experience. By being involved, they have effectively bought into and better appreciate the risks and the control measures needed, and thus are more likely to follow them.

5.9.1 Documentation

In many cases the person completing the risk assessment is not the person doing or directly supervising the work. There are many types of documentation with varying levels of complexity. Whilst a risk assessment or method statement is technically correct, it may be that it is in a format that is too complicated or long for workers to take in.



Asking the workforce to read lots of text and to obtain a signature to say they have read and understood the content before they start work is not helpful in achieving a safe and healthy workplace.

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If the workforce do not read or cannot understand everything provided, they will not appreciate the risks involved in the activity. In turn, they will not appreciate the consequences of failing to incorporate the required control measures, or understand why they are required, therefore continuing to work as they always have.

It may, therefore, be necessary to convert the findings of a risk assessment into a simpler document, both in terms of terminology and layout, which relates to what the workforce must do. Consideration should be given to the use of images or sketches of what is needed (such as a slinging arrangement or pictures of respiratory protective equipment being used correctly).

Involving the workforce in the risk assessment process is vital in developing a safe system of work that they feel comfortable with. It may well be that their preferred or alternative method of working is quicker and easier, but it has (or may have) additional risks. This can then be assessed and any necessary working practices amended and agreed, so that the workforce and their supervisors know they are following the risk assessment or method statement.

5.9.2 Language difficulties

The needs of any site workers who have poor, or no, understanding of either written or spoken English must be taken into account when compiling and communicating risk assessments. Consideration also needs to be given to how workers will be communicated with to ensure they are suitably engaged with and consulted.

Effective communication is an essential element of controlling risk; how such communication can be established must be a priority where there is the potential for language difficulties on site. Control measures can be put into place to ensure that the supervisor is able to communicate effectively with the workers, or to ensure that workers who do not understand English work with someone who can speak their language and interpret for them.



For further information refer to Chapter A07 Communication with non-English speaking workers.

5.9.3 Worker engagement in practice



The construction section of the HSE website contains a series of worker engagement case studies, which outline how businesses have introduced safe working practice and how they have used the HSE website to assist them in doing so.

5.10 Method statements

A method statement is a document prepared by an organisation that describes in a logical sequence exactly how a work activity is to be carried out in a manner which is safe and without risk to health.

To a large extent, the way that the job will be undertaken, and therefore detailed in the method statement, will reflect the findings of the risk assessment(s) for the same job. The methods identified for controlling risk will influence the way a job is carried out. In most cases, extensive reference to the risk assessment(s) will be necessary during the drafting of a method statement. Well-written method statements provide an ideal way of communicating vital health and safety information to those who will be doing the work, and others (such as contractors) who have an interest in how the job will be carried out.

For routine and repetitive activities (work that is carried out many times where the hazards and risk are the same) a previous method statement may be applied, again provided it has been reviewed at point of work (by the supervisor or person carrying out the work) to ensure that it is still relevant. This is known as a **generic method statement**.

Where the work is new, more complicated or unusual then a **specific method statement** will need to be produced. This can be a generic method statement updated to take the new situation into account. It should then be used to ensure that the work is carried out safely, properly and in the correct order.



For method statement guidance refer to Appendix A.

5.11 Permit to work

Whilst there is no requirement in law to use a permit to work system, they are often used to regulate how potentially high-risk activities are to be carried out in a healthy and safe manner. As such, they support the risk assessment from which they are derived. Permits to work are often, but not exclusively, required in the following situations.

- If the activity involves entry into a confined space.
- When the activity depends upon the isolation of high-voltage electrical equipment.
- If the activity involves the disturbance of any system carrying a fluid or gas under pressure.
- If the activity involves hot works.
- If the activity involves excavation work where services may be present.

A permit to work is a formal, dated and time-limited certificate signed by a properly authorised and competent person. Receipt of a permit is acknowledged by the signature of the person in charge of the work, who will retain a copy; another copy will be retained by the person issuing the permit to work.

Other signatures on the permit will certify that any control measures necessary for the job to start have been implemented (for example, using the lock-out, tag-out, try-out (LOTOTO) procedure on an electrical supply, or checking the atmosphere in a confined space). A permit will indicate the time and date at which it expires. If the work is not completed at that time, depending upon the circumstances:

- it is usually necessary to make everything safe, for everyone to leave the work area before the permit expires and for the permit to be cancelled
- it may be safe for the authorised person who issued the permit to extend the expiry time and for the work area to be reoccupied.

When the work is completed, or the expiry time has passed, the person in charge of the work must return their copy of the permit to the person who issued it and the permit is cancelled or extended.



More information on the permit to work can be found in GE700C 3.6.4.



To find examples of completed (qualitative) risk assessments, visit the HSE website.

RISK ASSESSMENTS, METHOD STATEMENTS AND PERMITS TO WORK - APPENDIX A

Appendix A – Method statement guidance

Method statements should be written clearly to enable those doing the work to fully understand the details of the job and its health and safety requirements. The suggested content for a method statement is outlined below.

If the work is of a simple or minor nature, a simplified form of method statement may be more appropriate. Alternatively, it may be preferable to use the format below, but to state 'Not applicable' in the inappropriate sections.

Validity	Insert the issue number of the method statement and brief details of the changes associated with each new issue. Identify the intended start and finish dates.
Hazards	List the known hazards associated with the work, as identified by the risk assessment.
Means of access and egress	Identify: ■ locations of work (for example, at height or in excavations) ■ access equipment required ■ specialist contractors involved.
Work details	Outline: ■ the limits of the work covered by this method statement ■ in a logical order, the list of work that makes up the whole job, indicating how health and safety issues will be addressed for identified hazards, including the protection of other trades.
Permits to work	Describe: ■ which tasks will be controlled by a permit to work (for example, hot works, excavation or breaking ground and work in confined spaces) ■ who will issue and co-ordinate the permits.
Supervision	Identify who will supervise the job and, if necessary, who will supervise different parts of the job. Identify contact details for all supervisors.
Workforce details	Identify: ■ the specific labour required to carry out the job in a safe and healthy manner ■ any special training or skills required ■ details of competence cards held.
Health and safety monitoring	Specify how day-to-day standards of health and safety will be monitored and controlled.
Plant inspection and operator training	Identify: ■ what items of plant and equipment will be used ■ operators' experience/qualifications ■ thorough examination and maintenance details.
Disconnection/reconnection of services	Identify: ■ which services must be isolated/reconnected ■ who will carry out the work ■ methods of locating underground services ■ who will certify that the services have been isolated/reconnected ■ method of isolation.
Hazardous substances	Identify: ■ the hazardous substances that will be used or disturbed ■ how those affected will be informed of the health hazards ■ the protective measures to be used ■ details of any sampling that may be required.
Occupational health assessments	Identify: ■ which works will require health surveillance for the operatives carrying them out ■ which operatives are affected ■ who will arrange for the health surveillance ■ who will carry out the health surveillance.

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Personal protective equipment (PPE)/ respiratory protective equipment (RPE)	Identify: ■ which items of PPE/RPE will be used, for which training will be required ■ who is responsible for arranging the training ■ who will carry out the training.
Emergency procedures	Identify: ■ possible causes of emergency or site evacuation ■ how emergency procedures will be communicated ■ who is responsible for calling the emergency services ■ contact details for out-of-hours emergencies ■ location map and contact details of nearest accident and emergency hospital.
Environmental controls	Describe: ■ threats to the environment arising from the work ■ which environmental protection measures will be put in place ■ how different types of waste will be managed, stored and disposed of.
Safety of the public and occupiers	Identify who will ensure that the health and safety of the public and other occupiers will be protected. Describe how the health and safety of the public, including, if necessary, the occupiers of the building, will be protected.
Public nuisance	Identify: ■ possible sources of nuisance for neighbouring people/properties ■ who will be responsible for neighbourhood liaison, and their contact details.
Briefing register	List by name those people to whom the method statement has been explained and consider including a signature block to indicate that the content has been understood.



For more information on risk assessment, method statement and permit to work templates, visit the HSE website.



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GT700 Toolbox talks/supporting guidance documents

Toolbox talks on some of these topics are available in the GT700 publication. Supporting guidance documents covering some of these topics are available on our companion website.



Scan the QR code to complete a brief survey, and share your feedback on the course.

Overview

Construction sites are dangerous places to work, even for experienced workers. It is a legal requirement to give everyone on site, whether new to the industry, experienced or even a temporary visitor, basic information about the site so they can remain safe and healthy. This is usually done in the form of a site induction and can vary in style, delivery method and length depending upon factors such as company induction procedures, location and size of site, type of work and client requirements.

Whatever the content, it is important that those attending understand it and that it is specific to the site.

This chapter explains why site inductions and training are important and offers some suggested content and strategy.

6.1 Introduction

It is a requirement of health and safety law that employees are provided with health and safety training whenever they are exposed to new or increased risks.

When employees first arrive in the company or at a new site, this training takes the form of an induction. It is a legal requirement under the **Construction (Design and Management) Regulations 2015** (CDM) that principal contractors and, where applicable, contractors must ensure a suitable site induction is provided. It is accepted that providing proper and effective health and safety induction training can have a significant impact on the likelihood of accidents and injuries during a person's first few days, weeks or months with a company or on a particular site.

Given that every accident occurring to an employee can be seen as an eventual financial cost to the employer, then anything that can be done to reduce accidents is of direct financial benefit to the employer. The costs of giving proper and effective health and safety induction training are relatively minor when viewed as one of the cost benefits that can accrue from accident avoidance and prevention. This also applies to the prevention of long-term ill health and the avoidance of dangerous occurrences.

6.2 Important points

- Everyone arriving on a new site, whether new to the industry, experienced or a visitor, should be given a site induction.
- Accident statistics show that the chances of accidents happening to people are increased during their first few days on site.
- The threats to health and safety will vary from site to site and even on the same site as work progresses and the hazards change.
- An effective induction process is an essential part of on-site health and safety management.
- The content of the induction must:
 - be understandable, comprehensive and relevant to the hazards present on site at that time
 - anticipate and inform inductees of forthcoming changes to the hazards on site
 - allow for the effective induction of inductees who do not speak English as their first language or may otherwise have difficulty in understanding what is being said.
- CDM place a specific duty on contractors and/or principal contractors (where appointed) to provide all of their workers with a site induction.

6.3 Induction requirements

Two types of induction are covered in this chapter: induction training and site inductions.

6.3.1 Induction training

Induction training is for new employees or for training existing employees in new topics or risks.

The Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations require every employer to ensure that employees are provided with adequate health and safety training in the following situations.

- During recruitment into the employer's undertaking.
- When exposed to new or increased risks because:
 - they have been transferred or given a change of responsibilities within the employer's undertaking
 - new work equipment or a change regarding work equipment already in use within the employer's undertaking has been introduced
 - new technology has been introduced into the employer's undertaking
 - a new system of work or a change regarding a system of work already in use within the employer's undertaking has been introduced.

6.3.2 Site inductions

CDM specifically require the following.

- That the principal contractor must ensure a suitable site induction is provided to every site worker.
- That contractors provide all of their workers with the information and training that is necessary for their health and safety, including a suitable site induction, where it is not provided by a principal contractor.

The above requirement on contractors to provide site inductions means that inductions must be carried out on any type, size and duration of a project. The requirements of other regulations, which in themselves indicate a need for competence in certain work situations, when viewed against the type of work to be carried out, might indicate additional topics that need to be covered during site induction.

6.3.3 Responsibilities of employers and employees

To assist in preparation and delivery of induction training, an aide-memoire of the responsibilities of employers and employees can be found in Appendices B and C. This could also help training providers with any questions that may arise during or after an induction training programme.

It will be for the employer to decide when and where the training takes place. Induction training should take place before anyone starts work and when they are new to the site.

It is important that the induction training is seen as a formal company procedure, which the company provides for the benefit of the inductee, so that the employer can be seen to be meeting both the letter and the spirit of the law.

If it is seen as 'something that is just necessary, we have to do it anyway' then it will fail to have the desired long-term effects.

The style and content of the induction will vary between company and site. However, the person facilitating it needs to have both the necessary skills and knowledge, together with the ability and presence to deliver it effectively and in a meaningful manner.

6.4 Types of inductees

The words *induction* or *inductee* may suggest that a person is totally new to the company or to working on site. Whilst this is the case for some people, there will be a significant number of people who do not fall into this category. In wider terms, the following could also be referred to as inductees.

- Young people joining the industry for the first time (this will generally be persons joining a company as trainees or apprentices).
- Persons arriving at a new site even though they have been in the industry for some time.
- Persons transferring between companies within the industry.
- Persons who have been promoted (for example, from tradesperson to chargehand).
- Employees who have been given different responsibilities (for example, employees who have successfully gained competence cards for specific items of plant and will now be driving plant on site as opposed to their former occupation).
- Those who do not regularly work on the site but visit occasionally (for example, architects or students).



The inductions should be proportionate to the nature of the visit.

It must be appreciated that different types of inductee will probably require different levels or styles of induction training because of their varying levels of knowledge, experience and competence within the industry.

It is only after induction, when they have all the appropriate information about company policy and site rules (including the principal contractor's site rules, where applicable), that they will be able to integrate into the workforce and work without risks to their own health and safety or to others who may be affected.

Escorted visitors only need to be made aware of the main hazards and control measures.

6.5 Induction difficulties

It is essential that the health and safety messages put across during site induction are fully understood by everyone. Possible barriers to learning will depend largely upon the training methods used. For example, reliance on written training materials will disadvantage those with reading difficulties.

Similarly, for workers where English is not their first language, the induction could be of limited value.

The person responsible for the training should establish the limitations of those undertaking induction, remembering that some inductees may be embarrassed about their limitations and reluctant to admit them.

To successfully induct those whose first language is not English, but who have some understanding, you will probably need to modify the delivery style, timescales and the aids used. Induction aids may need to be more visual, with less reliance upon the written word.

Where there are inductees who do not speak English at all, it is likely that specialist help, such as interpreters, will be required.

INDUCTION AND TRAINING

There may also be scope for training someone on the site who speaks both languages to carry out bilingual induction sessions for specific groups. Encouragement should be given to those who have reading, writing or language difficulties to seek help from appropriate sources.

Whatever the reason for any inductee experiencing difficulty in understanding what they have been told, all inductees must be given the opportunity to ask for any point to be rephrased in a different way.



For further information refer to Chapter A07 Communication with non-English speaking workers.

6.6 Induction content

Different companies will have different issues to include in the induction training. The requirements will vary as work on the site progresses. In the early days there may be demolition, excavations and other activities at ground level.

As the site and above-ground works progress, the hazards will change and it will be necessary for the emphasis in the health and safety training to change.

As the site develops, temporary or permanent traffic routes may be introduced, or the circulation of traffic on site may need to change (for example, due to the repositioning of a crane or the installation of services).

All these issues should be reflected in the induction training that will be provided for people arriving on site or as the project progresses. It is quite possible, or even likely, that the induction session delivered on day one of the project will not be valid after three months.

Part of the induction process must be to find out what the audience already knows, to identify the most important areas that must be covered and to use plain language, illustrating with diagrams, drawings and pictures to ensure that inductees can easily take in information.

At the end of the induction, an assessment of knowledge should take place, and written confirmation of attendance should be recorded.



Check that all inductees fully understand the induction content. Ask direct questions or check understanding by issuing a written test.

The induction should be site specific and highlight risks and control measures. The following should be considered.

- Outline of the project.
- Management of the project.
- First-aid arrangements.
- Accident and incident reporting arrangements.
- Arrangements for briefing workers on an ongoing basis (such as noticeboards and toolbox talks).
- Individuals' responsibility for health and safety.

This chapter contains some of the suggested topics and other examples that should be considered when induction training is to be given. It is not suggested that all are relevant to all sites or that issues relevant to more than one site should be given the same weighting.

They are given as an indication of subject areas that need to be covered – the depth to which they are covered will depend upon site conditions.

There will undoubtedly be other issues that are specific to a company or site and these will need to be considered and developed by the company concerned.

Appendix A contains a list of topics that should be considered for site induction content, together with a brief explanation of each.

In turn, some additional items not covered may be of particular importance to your company, and these should be included.

The comments made are of a general nature and do not attempt to explain the specific requirements of legislation.



Refer to the HSE website for an induction presentation template aimed at smaller construction companies.

6.7 Competency and card schemes

6.7.1 Competence

In 2011, following consultation with industry, research report RR877 was produced for the HSE, which addressed the construction industry routes to competence, including all the different competency card schemes.



The report can be downloaded from the HSE website.

6.7.2 Behavioural competence

The report supported a need for a broader definition of competence to include not only job competence and (above-basic) health and safety awareness, but a third strand of behavioural competence. This behavioural competence includes self-awareness, risk awareness and situational awareness.



Behavioural competence

Behavioural awareness comprises those individual behaviours, attitudes, self-awareness and limitations that impact upon performance and safety at work.

It covers the interaction between people and the environment in which they work, the equipment they use, and the procedures and techniques they use.

The objectives of behavioural competence are enhanced effectiveness and safety.

This expanded definition of competence is made up of three parts, and should include the following.

- **Occupational skills.**
- Deep and relevant **knowledge and understanding.**
- Ongoing evidence of **appropriate behaviours and attitudes**, to be embedded at all levels.

6.7.3 Supervisor and management competence

The report went on to say that qualifications should be enhanced to include mentoring and coaching skills in behavioural competence.

Over the years, many of the recommendations from the report have been incorporated into qualifications, training courses and development programmes for supervisors and management, such as those listed below.

- Alignment to new definitions of competence, behaviours and attitudes.
- A greater focus on **taught** qualifications whereby the basis of the input of knowledge is on risk, causation, person-management skills and situational awareness.
- Continued professional development (CPD) (a necessary aspect and a fundamental component).
- Opportunity to train people in roles to be effective assessors of staff.



For details of courses, training programmes or further information on competency visit the CITB website.

6.7.4 Card schemes

Access to construction sites may require a relevant scheme card. Different schemes have different requirements, such as an up-to-date *Health, safety and environment test*. The Construction Skills Certificate Scheme (CSCS) recently announced changes to the requirements, and how they are issued.

While all construction workers should hold the relevant CSCS card to access a construction site, people attending site to perform a non-construction related occupation should not be expected to carry a card. It will be the responsibility of site managers to induct non-construction related workers, and those on short-term work experience, before escorting them where appropriate so that they remain safe on site. Examples of various card schemes are highlighted in the table below.

General	CSCS	Construction Skills Certification Scheme.
Plant operatives	CPCS	Construction Plant Competence Scheme.
Demolition operatives	CCDO	Certificate of Competence for Demolition Operatives.
Scaffolders	CISRS	Construction Industry Scaffolders Record Scheme.
HVACR operatives	ESS	Engineering Services SKILLcard.
Plumbers	JIB-PMES	Joint Industry Board for Plumbing and Mechanical Engineering Services.
	SNIJIB	Scottish and Northern Ireland Joint Industry Board.



For more information, visit the CSCS website.

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6.7.5 Health, safety and environment test

The CITB *Health, safety and environment test* helps contribute towards a qualified workforce with the right skills, knowledge and training. For everyone working on UK construction sites the test helps to:

- raise health, safety and environmental standards
- support the prevention of incidents related to health, safety and the environment
- establish consistent standards.

Different tests have been developed to meet the demands of different trades and professions.



Visit the CITB website for more information about the tests and how to prepare for them.

6.8 Records

It is extremely important that records are kept showing which workers have attended site induction, together with details of the training they have received and the date it was carried out.

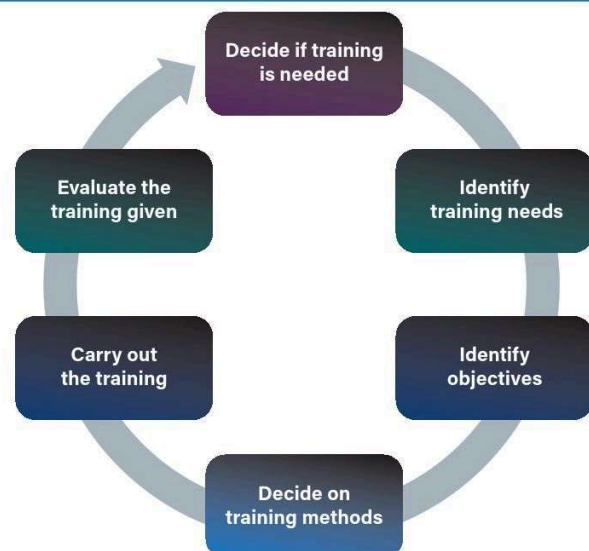
This will enable employers to demonstrate to the HSE, the client, the principal contractor and other interested parties that they have complied with the requirements of legislation and that they are committed to ensuring the health and safety of their employees and any others who may be affected.

Such records could help prove that health and safety induction training was given, should there be a legal challenge.

6.9 Ongoing training

Once the employee has been inducted to the site, and/or into the organisation, the company should ensure a training programme is implemented to help employees develop their knowledge, skills and attitudes, to ensure they are competent in health and safety aspects of their work.

A company could choose to implement a training cycle, which has six phases.



6.9.1 Phase 1. Deciding if training is needed

- Use information from job specifications, known abilities, experience and previous training records.
- Compare data against what the organisation requires the individual to know and to be able to do.
- Any variation between the two identifies a potential training requirement.

6.9.2 Phase 2. Identifying training needs

- Look at accident and health records and determine training requirements linked to causes and preventative means.
- Discuss procedures, materials and use of tools and equipment with employees to establish their understanding and highlight any skills gap.
- Observe and question employees whilst they are performing their roles and responsibilities.

6.9.3 Phase 3. Identifying objectives

- Does the law require you to carry out specific training (for example, first-aid training)?
- Clarify what the targeted employees should learn through their training.
- Priorities should include:
 - those where lack of information and/or training might result in serious harm
 - those that benefit the largest numbers of staff
 - new recruits or people new to the working environment
 - people changing jobs, working practices or taking on new responsibilities
 - people using new equipment.

- Consult employees, or their representatives, for their views.
- You must provide training during working hours and not at the expense of your employees.
- Special arrangements may be needed for part-timers or shift workers.

6.9.4 Phase 4. Deciding on training methods

- Organise training either internally or through external training providers.
- Ensure trainers are qualified and competent in their subject field.

6.9.5 Phase 5. Carrying out the training

- Trainers should encourage full engagement from the trainees.
- On-the-job training can generate new risks. Therefore, in some instances, off-site training may need to be completed.
- Use internal resources or external organisations.

6.9.6 Phase 6. Evaluating the training given

- Evaluate the effectiveness of the training programme.
- Determine if the training has achieved the objectives.
- Establish whether the training has been worth the money and time spent on delivery and attendance.
- The training plan, structure, content and methods may be subject to revision, following evaluation.

6.10 Promoting health and safety training

Health and safety training is sometimes viewed with suspicion, and those identified as requiring training can feel they are being picked on, or that their performance is thought to be substandard. Incentives (such as promotion or increased pay), applicable to some forms of training, do not generally result from health and safety training. Managers should encourage their employees to engage willingly and positively in such training. This task can be even more difficult in organisations with limited training history.

The following points may help in the initial planning stage of training.

- Encourage employees' genuine participation.
- Raise their awareness of the employer and employee responsibilities.
- Use relevant sector examples to illustrate the consequences of inadequate health and safety training.
- Inform employees about the organisation's training policy, including how individuals are chosen for training.
- Make arrangements for payment of wages or salaries during training, or reimbursements of expenses or fees paid.
- Support and reassure those who may lack confidence, especially those who have not attended training since leaving education.
- Make arrangements for knowledge checking during and after the delivery of training.
- Emphasise the value to everyone concerned of the short and long-term benefits of a working life free from injury and ill health.

 Visit the CITB website for advice on a range of health and safety training courses.



Worker loses sight in one eye because of insufficient training

A company was fined after a worker lost his sight in one eye when a compressed air hose whipped him in the face while he was carrying out maintenance work to clean a paint fume filter. When he had finished, he isolated the compressed air supply at the connection point and went to disconnect the equipment. However, he was unaware the pressure from the flexible hose needed venting before disconnection and, as a result, the hose whipped and struck him in the face, hitting his eye and breaking his cheekbone. The 49-year-old permanently lost the sight in his right eye, but he has been able to return to work.

The HSE investigation found the company had failed to provide the worker with sufficient information, instruction or training on the equipment he was using when the incident happened. The company pleaded guilty to breaching Section 2(1) of the Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974. They were fined £20,000 and ordered to pay £7,813.70 in costs.

After the hearing, an HSE inspector said: 'This was an entirely preventable incident that has resulted in a worker losing his sight in one eye – an injury which will affect him permanently. The sudden release of compressed air is a known hazard in industry. The company should have ensured that there was a safe system of work in place and that anyone working with compressed air had been given sufficient information, instruction and training to keep themselves and others safe from air blasts and whipping or snaking hoses.'

INDUCTION AND TRAINING – APPENDIX A

Appendix A – Site induction topics

Access and egress

Explain the rules regarding access to, and egress from, the workplace. Are there any one-way systems? Are there any prohibited areas? Are there any special rules or conditions applying to the site or workplace?

Accident reporting

Participants should be in no doubt of the requirements for reporting accidents, incidents and near misses. Explain when, where and to whom these must be reported and, in general, how they will be investigated. Procedures may go beyond those required by legislation as a company policy decision. Explain the importance of reporting all unsafe conditions and near misses and any site reporting scheme in operation. These can then be investigated, and appropriate remedial measures put in place, so that the next near miss does not become an accident.

Alcohol and drugs

Explain the rules or company policy about arriving or being on site under the influence of alcohol or drugs, or consuming or dealing them during the hours of employment, including action that will be taken. There may be a policy of random testing and/or post-incident testing, and this should also be explained. The issue of prescribed drugs and use of some over-the-counter medicines should also be covered, as some can have side effects, such as drowsiness. If the user is authorised to operate plant or drive vehicles, this needs to be addressed and resolved with the supervisor or management. The support provided to individuals who disclose that they have a drugs or alcohol problem must be made clear, as well as the prescribed limits of both alcohol and drugs, and the consequences of a negative result.

Asbestos

If the project is a new build on a greenfield site, the probability of finding asbestos is remote. However, if it is on a brownfield site, there may be asbestos in the ground, and if carrying out a refurbishment or renovation on a building/grounds built before 2000, there is a significant chance of discovering asbestos within the existing structure or surrounding grounds. If asbestos-containing materials are potentially present, it is a legal requirement to provide asbestos awareness training, including details of any prohibited areas, to reflect the site conditions. You should have a company policy for dealing with any material suspected of being asbestos, and staff should be informed of this policy.

Assembly points

See also **emergency procedures**. Explain where the assembly points are for site evacuation in the event of an emergency.

Boundaries

Explain the boundaries of the site if there is no perimeter fence. Include the prevention of trespass.

CDM

Explain any appropriate on-site rules, the provisions the principal contractor has made for consultation with the workforce and where the F10 form (if the project is notifiable) is displayed.

Competence

You may need to advise staff and others of the levels of competence required for operating certain types of plant or carrying out certain activities. See also **registration schemes**.

Confidential issues

Explain the provision for 'whistle blowing'. Also how staff can raise confidential (including medical) issues if the need arises.

Confined spaces

Explain the rules that apply on site. Many staff will fail to recognise that a confined space can be above ground, or be as innocuous as a sub-basement boiler room. Unfortunately, confined spaces have been responsible for a number of deaths in the industry, all of which could have been avoided by compliance with proper health and safety procedures.

Consultation with employees

It is a legal requirement to consult with staff, which should be two-way. Key points to communicate during induction should include:

- the mechanism for workers to bring any health and safety concerns to the attention of site management
- whether there is a health and safety committee on site and, if so, who the members are
- whether there are any trade union-appointed representatives and, if so, who they are.

If there is a suggestion box or scheme, explain how staff can put forward ideas for improvements in health, safety and welfare, waste minimisation and so on, on a day-by-day basis.

Contamination

Raised environmental awareness makes the prevention of ground contamination increasingly important. Explain how staff can prevent spillage of diesel fuel, paint, oil, thinners, cement, concrete or any other substance that could lead to contamination.

Control of substances hazardous to health (COSHH)

Explain on-site procedures relating to hazardous substances. Are there any additional substances to the usual cement, oils, paints, and so on?

Competency card schemes

Explain the requirements for competency cards. See also [registration schemes](#).

Dangerous occurrences

Explain the reporting policy for dangerous occurrences. It is thought that many go unreported as staff regard them as an accident where nobody was injured. Given this could lead to company prosecutions, it is important that appropriate instructions are given at inductions.

Dermatitis

Explain that contact dermatitis can be caused by relatively common substances (such as diesel and mould release oil, paints, thinners and cement). When appropriate, gloves should be worn and barrier creams should be properly used, with situations identified by risk assessments.

Discipline

Explain the company policy regarding breaches of health and safety legislation, site or company rules.

Dress code

Explain the effects of sun exposure and the importance of preventing skin cancer. Explain company or site rules on whether shorts or sleeveless vests are permissible on site.

Drones

If drones are being used on site for surveying or other purposes, the protocols and risks presented during drone operations must be explained.

Drying rooms

Explain the location and use of drying rooms, and who is responsible for maintaining cleanliness, tidiness and disposal of discarded or abandoned clothing and equipment.

Edge protection

Explain the standard that is used and the safe system of work for persons working on or near open or leading edges.

Electricity

Explain the site or company rules concerning:

- temporary or permanent repairs by competent persons on site
- use of 230-volt equipment
- use of RCDs or circuit breakers
- use of transformers and 110-volt equipment
- testing, inspection and maintenance of portable electrical equipment (PAT testing).

Emergency procedures

Explain site or company procedures. What is the siren or alarm? Where are the emergency evacuation assembly points? Explain procedures to be followed in the event of an emergency other than fire. This may be civil disturbance, a bomb scare, structural collapse or other eventuality.

Environment

Environmental pollution can affect air, ground or water. Explain specific issues of protection and control concerning the company or site; procedures to be followed in the event of an incident (for example, spills); and how everyone is expected to positively contribute. Also explain how everyone on the site can positively contribute to the environmental agenda and encourage these behaviours.

Escape routes

Explain recognised routes on site and from buildings in the event of emergency, and that access/egress routes must be well-defined and kept clear. How are they marked? How will they be lit when dark, or during winter? How will changes be shared as construction progresses?

INDUCTION AND TRAINING – APPENDIX A

Excavations

Explain the policy regarding:

- permit-to-dig systems
- excavation support and inspections
- proper entry and exit from an excavation, and edge protection around an excavation.

Eye protection

Explain if there are any specific eye protection issues, or rules applicable to the site or any particular work that is taking place.

See also **personal protective equipment**.

Fall arrest

You may wish to comment on the use of safety nets, safety decking, air bags and other similar systems. See also **safety harnesses**.

Fall prevention

Explain hierarchy of control measures used to prevent falls or safely catch those who fall. This will vary depending on the type of site and work.

Fire

In the induction session you should at least cover the following.

- Fire precautions, fire prevention and good housekeeping.
- Who will be responsible for calling the emergency services.
- Location of fire points and fire extinguishers.
- Training and competence in the use of fire-fighting equipment.
- Testing of the fire alarm, fire drills and practice evacuations.
- Policy for hot works, including permits.

First aid

Clearly explain the arrangements for first-aid provision.

- The location of the first-aid kit(s).
- The details of the first aider(s), emergency first aider(s) or appointed persons (and mental health first aiders, if on site), and how they can be identified and contacted in the event of an emergency.
- Location of the first-aid room (where provided).
- Emergency procedures that should be taken in the event of an injury.
- Location of the nearest accident and emergency hospital (with map, address and contact details).
- Employers have a responsibility to take account of employees' mental health within the first-aid needs assessment.

Flammable liquids

If flammable liquids (such as paint thinners, solvents, spirit-based paints and others) are kept and used on site, explain the rules for:

- storage
- withdrawal from storage
- use and return to storage.

Health and safety committee

See also **consultation with employees**. If there is a site health and safety committee, explain the terms of reference for:

- the committee, membership and how often the committee meets
- agenda items and how the outcomes of meetings are made known to staff on site.

Health surveillance and screening

If mandatory surveillance is a legal requirement due to the associated health risks of site activities, then the process needs to be discussed. This must also include awareness of general health screening programmes that are aligned to the occupational health and wellbeing strategy.

Hearing protection zones

See also **noise**. Are there any mandatory hearing protection zones on site? How are they marked? Explain the supply and issue of hearing protectors and when they should be worn.

High-visibility clothing

Explain the site or company rules for when this clothing should be worn and clearly define the appropriate locations. Also clearly define the standard for high-visibility clothing.

Hoists

Explain the site or company rules for passenger hoists.

- Who is the competent person to operate the hoist?
- If anyone can operate it, do they need training prior to being authorised as competent?
- What is the maximum number of people permitted in the hoist?

- Which rules apply regarding goods carried in the hoist?
- If controls are seen as so simple that the hoist may almost be regarded a public lift, is there any danger of control override?

Explain the site or company rules for goods hoists.

- Explain that passengers cannot be carried
- Who is the authorised competent person to operate it? Can any other persons be authorised?

- What are the rules for closing the gates and what is the rated capacity (safe working load)?

Ladders/stepladders

Explain the company standards and site rules for:

- any restrictions on use of ladders/stepladders (permits)
- where used, the securing or tying of ladders/stepladders

- use of ladders/stepladders for light work of short duration or for gaining access.

Lasers

If lasers are to be used on site, explain what class of laser is to be used and what, if any, hazards could be caused. Levelling lasers (used, for example, by suspended ceiling fixers) are not normally regarded as hazardous as long as appropriate health and safety rules are followed.

Legal issues

Discuss any particular points of law that apply to the company/site. Explain that different projects/clients have different rules, and that staff should understand the need for rules and how they are enforced. Give the location of the health and safety law poster that must be displayed.

Lifting equipment

Explain the site or company rules for:

- who has authority to use lifting equipment of various sizes/types
- the duties of slingers and signallers
- testing and inspection of equipment, and current colour coding, if such a system is used.

Lighting

Explain the site or company rules for provision of work lighting and emergency lighting, including:

- the placing of luminaires
- extra lighting during winter or for work outside normal hours.

Liquefied petroleum gas

Explain the rules for:

- use, storage and separation of full and empty cylinders
- separation from oxygen and acetylene, as appropriate
- use of hose check valves and flashback arresters
- emergency procedures and use of fire extinguishers.

Manual handling

Explain the site or company rules for:

- the avoidance of manual handling wherever possible
- the use of mechanical devices to aid manual handling
- safe systems of work.

Method statements

Explain the importance of supervisors discussing the method statement to be used for particular tasks, and the benefits to be gained from staff input. Method statements must be specific to the site, task and persons carrying out the work.

Mobile elevating work platforms (MEWPs)

Explain who is competent to operate or use MEWPs, and the evidence required to prove competence and training. Where can MEWPs be used, and under what ground conditions? Where are they not allowed? Explain safety harness use when working from platforms; actions and procedures for emergency lowering controls; and any rescue plans for entrapment and requirements for using anti-crush protection systems.

INDUCTION AND TRAINING – APPENDIX A

Needles and syringes

Staff should be warned to be vigilant, particularly regarding the discovery of used hypodermic syringes (needles and risk of needlestick injury) and other drug-taking equipment. Explain actions to be taken on finding discarded needles or receiving a needlestick injury. Explain who is responsible for safely removing any sharps, and how this person can be identified and contacted in the event of any being found. It should be noted that most gloves in common use on site do not offer any protection against a needlestick injury. Suitable training should be provided to nominated individuals for safe handling and disposal of any discovered sharps, and use of specialist gloves and equipment.

Noise

See also **hearing protection zones**. Explain the site or company rules concerning the use of equipment that produces excessive noise. Does the Local Authority impose any restrictions? Explain the use of hearing protection and noise control zones.

Occupational health

Stress the importance of reporting any cases of ill health to supervisors, as it may be potentially work-related. This is particularly important if staff are working where there may be rats, or if the area has been used for illegal drug taking and related materials may be found. In the case of refurbishment and renovation works, there may be residual materials from previous occupants likely to cause ill health.



Construction dusts are the biggest cause of construction-related ill health, with over 5,000 people a year dying from respiratory diseases. Risk assessments and method statements must identify dust produced in any activity as a hazard, and control measures put in place to minimise exposure.

Overhead electricity cables

Explain the site or company rules on:

- location and marking
- allowable proximity for vehicles
- working nearby and precautions.

Permits to work

Explain company or site procedures regarding issuing, working with and the cancellation of permits to work. Where lock-off systems are used, explain the rules regarding padlock keys.

Personal protective equipment (PPE)

Explain the site or company rules regarding:

- minimum PPE (for example, safety helmets, safety footwear, high-visibility clothing, light eye protection and gloves)
- storage and maintenance of PPE (for example, light eye protection cleaning stations)
- respiratory protective equipment (RPE) and task-specific PPE
- any other issues (such as dress code).

Remind staff that PPE generally, and RPE particularly, should be a last resort when all other control measures have been considered and found unworkable. Other than mandatory PPE, the need for PPE should be covered in the risk assessment and method statement.



Where task-specific PPE has been identified, the type or grade must be stated (for example, rather than just specifying 'dust mask' the type must be stated, such as 'FFP3-rated half-mask respirator').

Plant and equipment

Explain the site rules regarding:

- the authority to operate plant and equipment, including the requirement for competence cards, where necessary
- the need for noise control where appropriate
- any type of plant or equipment that is prohibited (for example, mains-powered hand tools)
- the requirement for permits to work where appropriate.

Registration schemes

Explain the site or company rules regarding registration schemes.

Reporting defects

Explain the importance of reporting all defects in plant and equipment, scaffolding, excavation supports, and so on. Early reporting will allow swift remedial measures, and help prevent accidents. Possible consequences of not doing so may be accidents or disciplinary procedures.

Restricted or prohibited areas

Explain whether there are any areas on site that are restricted to all people, or a specific class of people. Include what identifies a restricted area – typical examples are areas where demolition, impact cleaning, water jetting, or asbestos removal are taking place.

Risk assessments

Explain the significant findings of risk assessments, as they will affect staff on site as a whole, or those working on a particular activity. It may be useful to explain the risk assessment process and the health and safety benefits that can be gained. See also [method statements](#).

Safe systems of work

The crucial need arising out of risk assessments and method statements is for safe systems of work. Explain that site rules require staff to work in accordance with any safe systems of work that have been developed by the employer.

Safety harnesses

Explain the company or site requirements for inspecting, wearing, using and maintaining safety harnesses and lanyards. See also [fall arrest](#).

Safety policy

Explain any relevant areas of the company's health and safety policy, together with the organisation and arrangements for the implementation of the policy. If relevant, explain where a copy of the policy is displayed on site.

Safety signs and notices

Remind all staff that they must comply with all safety signs and notices at all times. Explain the whereabouts of any site noticeboard, hazard board and how changes and modifications to site rules will be made known to the workforce.

Scaffolding (including mobile access towers)

Explain the site rules regarding:

- who is allowed to erect, alter and dismantle tube and fitting/ system-built scaffolds
- the implications (safety/disciplinary) of unauthorised dismantling or alteration
- the safe use of mobile access towers
- safe access to and egress from scaffolds
- assessing competency to erect proprietary mobile access towers.

Explain any other company or site-specific rules about the use of scaffolding as either a working place or as access to the working place.

Site layout

Explain whether any specific rules apply to pedestrian and traffic movement. This will depend on the size and complexity of the site. You may also include where contractors may lay down materials and which areas they may use for the prefabrication of components.

Site security

Security is very much allied to health and safety in that a breach of security can lead to trespassers on site and possible exposure to a risk of injury. Open a discussion if you have any particular company or on-site rules concerning security. Also consider the issue of health and safety awareness of site security staff, whether they are staff or a sub-contracted security company.

Skin protection

It may be appropriate to discuss the need for skin protection, both in terms of gloves and barrier creams. If barrier creams and rehydrating lotions are used, where are they dispensed? Also explain that the types of gloves used must be the most suitable for the levels of protection needed. If likely to be a significant hazard, you should also include details of the risk of skin cancer associated with excessive sun exposure.

Smoking

Explain the policy on smoking and vaping in the workplace and the welfare areas, clearly identifying areas where smoking is not allowed.

Sustainability

Explain the policy on sustainability in terms of suppliers, materials and procedures.

Tidiness (housekeeping)

Explain the importance of maintaining a tidy site in order to eliminate many of the slip, trip and fall hazards. Include:

- materials storage and delivery arrangements
- how materials are to be distributed and returned
- how and when to remove rubbish and excess materials
- who is responsible for organising delivery and removal of skips
- good housekeeping, sweeping up, vacuuming and dust extraction (general tidiness)
- maintaining tidy workplaces, access routes, staircases and cable management.

INDUCTION AND TRAINING – APPENDIX A

Toilets

See also **welfare facilities**. Explain site/company rules on cleanliness, abuse of facilities/graffiti, and consequences. Include defect reporting.

Traffic routes

These are dependent on the size and complexity of the site. Explain:

- one-way systems and the need to minimise or avoid reversing
- segregation of pedestrians from vehicles and plant and machinery (pedestrian walkways).
- duties of the vehicle marshaller

Training

What training will be given to persons on site? Explain the need for all contractors to ensure that staff are trained and competent.

Underground services

Explain site/company procedures if underground services (gas, electricity, telecommunications, fibre optics, water, sewerage) are discovered.

Vehicles

Explain the rules for the presence and operation of vehicles on site. Include:

- the parking of private vehicles
- deliveries (access constraints, timings, restrictions, off-loading methods (tower crane/telehandler), HIABs and fall prevention)
- who is allowed to operate plant on site (proof of competence)
- security measures to make vehicles unavailable to trespassers and children during non-working hours
- keeping clear of site (working) vehicles
- traffic routes, speed limits and noise (for example, time limitations imposed by the Local Authority).
- the security of vehicle keys when not in use

Vibration

Explain the potential severity of hand-arm vibration syndrome (HAVS), the risks of whole-body vibration (WBV), and company/site policy on:

- hand-held vibrating equipment and maximum trigger use times
- rest breaks and the rotation of work
- plant/vehicle operator training, smooth operation and job rotation
- the symptoms of HAVS and WBV
- the use and limitations of PPE
- the arrangements for health surveillance
- the design and selection of tools and equipment
- the need for staff to seek medical advice if they have symptoms.

Waste disposal

Give skip/waste container locations. Explain segregation; responsibility for removal; and site/company policy if contractors don't remove waste.

Waste minimisation

Explain that this is a financial as well as environmental matter, closely linked with site tidiness, pollution control, housekeeping and accident prevention. There are company and national benefits, and projects are more likely to finish on time and to budget. See also **environment**.

Welfare facilities

Explain:

- location of facilities and (if appropriate) canteen opening hours
- the provision of barrier creams and rehydrating lotions
- responsibilities for cleaning and maintenance of the facilities
- the need for good personal hygiene.

Working at height

This is allied to fall prevention, safe systems of work and PPE. Explain the company or site rules for:

- working at height, including safe systems of work
- protection of those below, including the public
- competence of employees
- prevention of materials falling (containment and debris nets).

Working near, on or over water

Explain the site or company rules for working near, on or over water, including:

- wearing of lifejackets, buoyancy aids or other flotation devices
- the rescue of anyone who has fallen into water, plus lookouts and alarms.
- prevention of falls into water

Appendix B – Employer responsibilities

The following information is provided as an aide-memoire, for any questions that may arise during or after an induction training programme.

Set out below, in an abbreviated form, are the principal responsibilities of employers, managers and supervisors. For ease of presentation, the reader is assumed to be an employer (this list is not exhaustive).

- Ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, the health, safety and welfare of employees.
- Display an employer's liability compulsory insurance certificate.
- Have a general statement of health and safety policy.
- Prepare and display a written health and safety policy, if you employ five or more persons.
- Make employees aware of your company health and safety policy.
- Display an approved poster (such as the health and safety law poster) or give each employee a copy of an approved leaflet to comply with the Health and Safety (Information for Employees) Regulations 1989.
- Carry out risk assessments of your work and record the significant findings, if you employ five or more persons.
- Implement any control measures identified by your risk assessment.
- Regularly review risk assessments and any associated control measures.
- Ensure that scaffolding is only erected, altered or dismantled under the supervision of a competent person.
- Appoint a competent person to assist the company with health and safety requirements, where necessary.
- Establish a safety committee, if requested by two union-appointed safety representatives.
- Assess manual handling operations in the workplace and take appropriate steps to reduce the risk of injury to employees.
- Ensure all accidents that result in injury, however slight, are entered in the accident book and investigated.
- Report to the HSE all reportable accidents, dangerous occurrences and notifiable diseases.
- Provide employees with PPE, as necessary.
- Avoid entry into confined spaces, wherever possible.
- Protect employees and others who may be exposed to asbestos as a result of any work that may cause exposure.
- Ensure that all excavations are safe and that work in excavations is carried out safely.
- Provide sufficient and suitable welfare facilities on construction sites, including sanitary conveniences, washing facilities, drinking water and changing facilities.
- Provide information, instruction, training and supervision to ensure the health and safety of all employees.
- Appoint trained and competent persons for the purpose of selecting and mounting abrasive wheels.
- Examine, test and properly maintain plant, equipment, cranes, lifting appliances and associated working gear (lifting accessories) at regular intervals, and record the findings.
- Provide adequate first-aid facilities with sufficiently trained first aiders and appointed persons.
- Consult with your employees on health and safety matters.
- Authorise only competent persons to carry out work on electrical installations and appliances.
- Take measures to prevent or adequately control employees' exposure to harmful dusts and fumes.
- Prepare and maintain a construction phase plan appropriate to your operations.
- Ensure that the workplace is safe and without risk to the health of employees.
- Take the necessary steps to ensure that the health and safety of the public is not put at risk by works being carried out.

INDUCTION AND TRAINING – APPENDIX C

Appendix C – Employee responsibilities

Below, in an abbreviated form, are the main responsibilities of employees (this list is not exhaustive). The reader is assumed to be an employee.

- Co-operate with your employer and follow any information, instructions and training given to you.
- Do not interfere with or misuse anything that has been provided in the interests of health, safety and welfare.
- Take reasonable care at all times and make sure that you do not endanger yourself or any other person.
- Use all tools and equipment safely and in accordance with instructions given or training received.
- Report any defects or potential hazards in equipment to your supervisor as soon as possible.
- Make proper use of any safe system of work or mechanical means provided by your employer in connection with manual handling.
- Only operate the plant and equipment you have been trained and authorised to use.
- Use the PPE supplied by your employer correctly, take care of it and report any loss or defects in the equipment.
- Report to your employer any work situation that might present a danger.
- Do not erect, alter or dismantle scaffolding unless competent to do so or under the supervision of a competent person.
- When operating goods hoists, keep the gates closed except when loading. Do not override any controls. Do not allow any passengers.
- Use only the proper safe means provided for entering and leaving an excavation.
- Do not block or obstruct any access or escape route.
- Make full use of any control measures provided to prevent or limit exposure to substances hazardous to health, and wear the PPE provided.
- Observe safe use and handling instructions for hazardous substances, and return unused quantities to the designated store.
- Do not use a MEWP for any use other than as a work platform.
- Co-operate with health and safety inspectors, as required.
- Do not remove safety guards or stop any safety device fitted to any plant or equipment from working.
- Do not ride on plant or vehicles in unauthorised and insecure places.
- Recognise the importance of personal cleanliness, especially when working with substances harmful to the skin.
- Never exceed the rated capacity (safe working load) of any equipment.
- Report to your supervisor all accidents that cause any injury to you.
- Understand and comply with all signs that are displayed.
- Wear hearing protection in designated areas where mandatory warning signs are displayed.
- Follow all company and site health and safety rules.

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GT700 Toolbox talks/supporting guidance documents

Toolbox talks on some of these topics are available in the GT700 publication. Supporting guidance documents covering some of these topics are available on our companion website.



Scan the QR code to complete a brief survey, and share your feedback on the course.

COMMUNICATION WITH NON-ENGLISH SPEAKING WORKERS

Overview

Good communication is essential for the management of health and safety on construction sites.

Communication problems can occur where workers have limited or no understanding of English, particularly during site induction.

This chapter offers advice to those who may not have company communication policies, and offers some suggested approaches.

7.1 Introduction

The number of workers whose first language is not English has increased on UK sites over recent years. Some of these workers have excellent skills in spoken and written English, but there are others for whom understanding English is a problem. This can be a barrier to effective communication of health and safety information.

However, failure to engage with non-English speaking workers for this reason will be in breach of the provisions of health, safety and equality-based legislation. The Health and Safety Executive (HSE) legal (L) series guidance on the Construction (Design and Management) Regulations 2015 (CDM) states:

Anyone with a duty under CDM to provide health and safety information or instructions to anyone else must ensure that it is easy to understand.



Any information or instruction provided should be in simple, clear English (and/or other languages, where appropriate). It should also be set out in a logical order and have illustrations where appropriate.

7.2 Important points

- Employers are legally required to provide information that is comprehensible – in other words, provided in a format that can be understood by the worker.
- This requirement can result in problems where the recipients of the information have limited or no understanding of English, particularly during site induction.
- Communicating using images has the potential to overcome these problems, regardless of the mix of languages spoken on site.
- It may be necessary to hold separate training sessions to assess the understanding of safety critical words and phrases by workers with English language problems.
- Confirming that the workers being assessed can associate each image with a spoken short phrase in plain English will give supervisors and managers confidence that the workers have an understanding of safety critical words in English.
- The simplicity of these phrases aids translation into other languages, if needed.
- Before using any images, workers' competence, training and language skills must be assessed. This will also indicate the level of supervision required generally.
- The images can be used to support site inductions, toolbox talks or other training, or superimposed on site plans to identify the location of welfare facilities, fire-fighting equipment, and so on.
- The images also help to fill gaps in translation, as well as improving memory recall of site rules.
- If appropriate, the images can enhance and complement existing procedures (for example, using interpreters) rather than replace them.
- An understanding of the images should not be solely relied upon to ensure that work of a higher risk nature can be carried out safely.

7.3 Managing the language situation

Contractors who employ workers who cannot speak and/or understand English have several options when deciding how to manage communications. These include hiring a bilingual supervisor who can give information, instruction and training to workers. Alternatively, English speaking co-workers are often used on site to communicate with non-English speaking workers. However, their competence (both technically in construction and as a translator) must be assessed first.

Another option is for training materials to be translated or to be represented in a pictorial form (images) (*refer to 7.5*). The effectiveness of images to overcome language barriers has been confirmed through research. The images were developed from British Standard safety signs, HSE guidance documents and other picture-based guidance. These were tested for comprehension on live sites with foreign workers and refined to help contractors to carry out effective health and safety training and, in so doing, discharge their legal duties.

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They were developed for a generic site induction and targeted at the most critical health, safety and welfare issues relevant to construction workers. However, these are only examples of a larger database of images.

7.4 Pre-start assessments

Before any worker starts on site the following facts must be established.

- The worker's competence and training.
- The worker's understanding of English.
- Supervision required.

The type of work to be done by the worker will dictate the required level of competence and identify any training needed. Regardless of language issues foreign workers must meet the level of competence and training expected of **any** worker asked to do the task(s). Therefore, contractors should apply the same criteria for non/low-English speaking workers as they do for English speakers, which will require some form of competency assessment. It is possible that some foreign workers will have trade qualifications gained in their home countries.



UK ENIC – the UK National Information Centre for the recognition and evaluation of international qualifications and skills – offers a service to compare overseas qualifications with UK ones. Although not comprehensive, it is a useful resource.

With regard to training undertaken in the United Kingdom, holding a valid CSCS, CPCS or similar card will indicate that an acceptable level of training has been undertaken and a minimum level of health and safety knowledge is held. Failure to prove an acceptable level of competence will indicate that further training is required before considering the other pre-start factors. (Such training is beyond the scope of this chapter.)

Assuming that the worker meets the contractor's competence criteria, the next thing to consider is the worker's language skills. NARIC can also provide assistance in this respect. There are a number of methods for assessing a worker's English language skills, which use simple self-assessment criteria. One of these is the Association of Language Testers in Europe (ALTE) 'can do' statements. These can be objectively described and assessed by non-specialists. Therefore, a worker's language skills can be easily determined by site managers and supervisors by following the guidance provided in the ALTE work statements summary (see table below and overleaf).

Workers below ALTE breakthrough level are those with no English language skills whatsoever, who need an interpreter or written translation for all communications. Furthermore, it may be unwise to assume these workers can read in their own language. To prove their competence these workers will have to demonstrate their understanding of the images without the benefit of reference to the phrases. Most workers who have lived and worked in the UK for at least one year may have picked up a basic level of understanding of English at listening breakthrough level or Level 1. Workers at this level will find the images and phrases to be useful learning aids.

Co-workers, who can interpret for their colleagues, will need to be at least ALTE Level 3 for listening and speaking. The presence of an interpreter does not make the images redundant as they can still fill gaps that may be lost in translation. The combination of competence, training and language skills will dictate the level of supervision required. Another factor, as with any worker, will be the result of the employer's risk assessment for the task(s).

However, where there is a language barrier to communication, the level of supervision will also have to consider an appropriate ratio of workers to each bilingual supervisor. This can vary from as much as 1:20 to 1:1 depending on the circumstances. Where workers are grouped close together in the same area and undertaking low-risk work the ratio can be high. But, if the workers are dispersed around the site and/or undertaking higher risk work, the ratio may need to be as low as 1:1. Lone working for workers with no/low English language skills is not recommended.

ALTE work statements summary table			
ALTE level	Listening or speaking	Reading	Writing
ALTE breakthrough level	CAN take and pass on simple messages of a routine kind, such as 'Friday meeting 10 a.m.'	CAN understand short reports or product descriptions on familiar matters, if these are expressed in simple language and the contents are predictable.	CAN write a simple routine request to a colleague, such as 'Can I have 20X please?'
ALTE Level 1	CAN state simple requirements within own job area, such as 'I want to order 25 of...'	CAN understand most short reports or manuals of a predictable nature within their area of expertise, provided enough time is given.	CAN write a short, comprehensible note of request to a colleague or a known contact in another company.
ALTE Level 2	CAN offer advice to clients within own job area on simple matters.	CAN understand the general meaning of non-routine letters and theoretical articles within own work area.	CAN make reasonably accurate notes at a meeting or seminar where the subject matter is familiar and predictable.
ALTE Level 3	CAN take and pass on most messages that are likely to require attention during a normal working day.	CAN understand most correspondence, reports and factual product literature they are likely to come across.	CAN deal with all routine requests for goods or services.

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ALTE Level 4	CAN contribute effectively to meetings and seminars within own area of work and argue for or against a case.	CAN understand correspondence expressed in non-standard language.	CAN handle a wide range of routine and non-routine situations in which professional services are requested from colleagues or external contacts.
ALTE Level 5	CAN advise on/handle complex, delicate or contentious issues, such as legal or financial matters, to the extent that they have the necessary specialist knowledge.	CAN understand reports and articles likely to be encountered during their work, including complex ideas expressed in complex language.	CAN make full and accurate notes and continue to participate in a meeting or seminar.

(Reproduced with permission from ALTE.)



For further information on the ALTE Can Do project visit the ALTE website.

7.5 Critical health, safety and welfare images

Each image is set out in a similar format, as shown to the right and below on this page.

The **reference number** at the top of each image is for ease of identification. The next element is a **short phrase or sentence**. These have been developed, with help from language experts, to:

- communicate, in plain English, the particular health and safety issue depicted by the graphical symbol
- aid translation into other languages.

The phrase or sentence will remind the person delivering the training of the response required from the person being assessed during the induction. Depending on circumstances, a decision will have to be made as to whether it is more beneficial to reveal or hide the phrase or sentence during the assessment. Having sight of the phrase or sentence may have the potential to help workers with a limited understanding of written English to associate the written words with the message of the graphical symbol.

The **graphical symbol** is the main element in each image. Most are self-explanatory. Some enable the person delivering the training to add site-specific information (for example, the postal address or telephone number).

As demonstrated in the figures below, it is recommended that some images are regarded as linked, and are shown sequentially to convey the correct meaning.

If image 3.7 is shown to a worker who cannot understand the written phrase, it could be misinterpreted as 'the site is closed' or 'keep out'. However, by showing image 3.6 and 3.7 in sequence, a visual link is created and the chance of misinterpretation is reduced.

5.13

Wear the correct PPE (protection) for cutting



Reference number

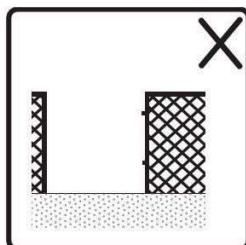
Phrase or sentence

Graphical symbol

Space for notes or translation

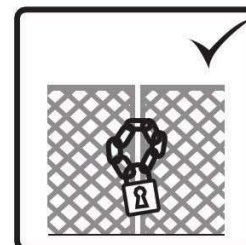
3.6

Do not leave the gate open



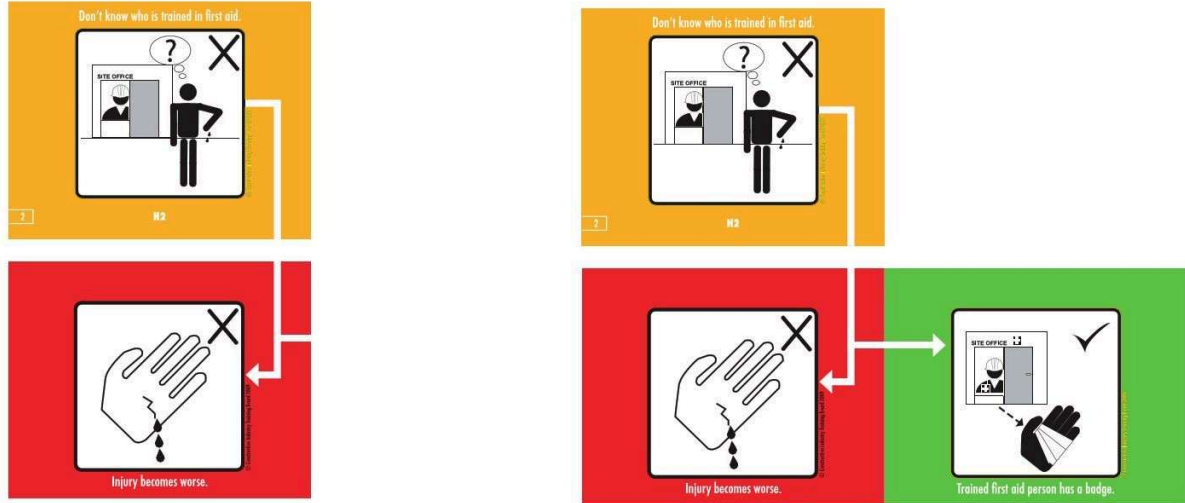
3.7

Keep the gate locked

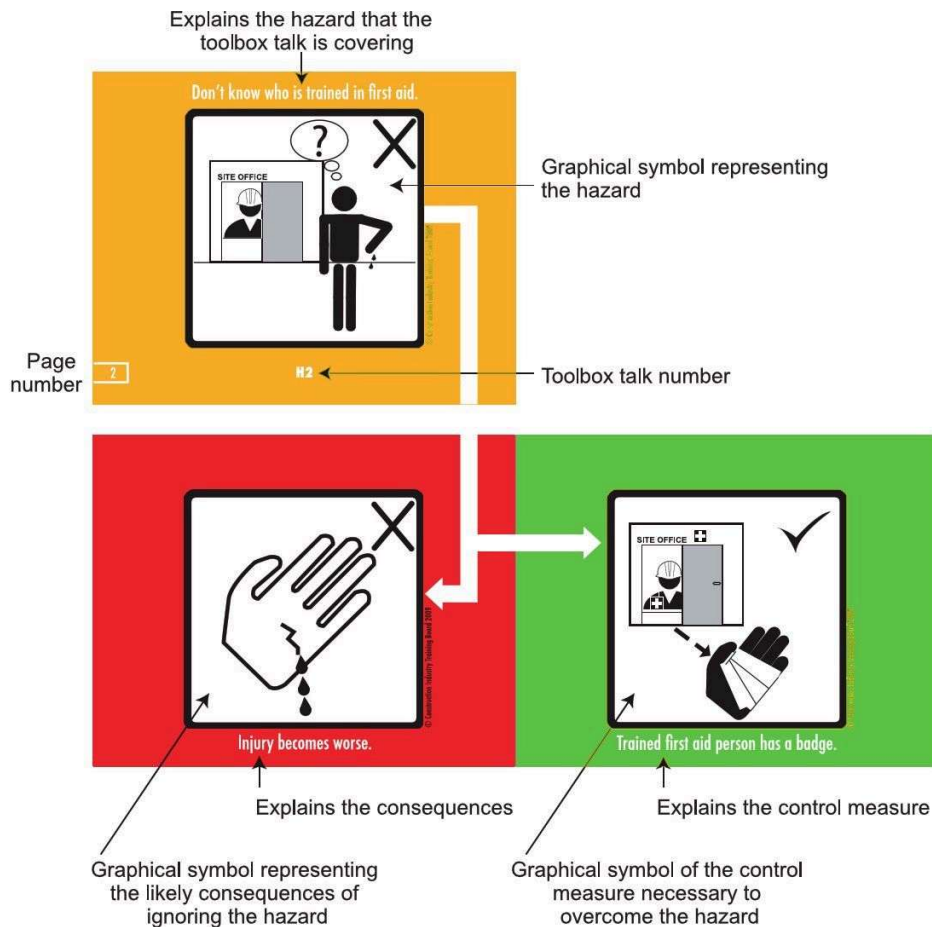


7.6 Delivering a safety-critical communication toolbox talk

1. Find the hazard in the contents list.
2. Turn to the appropriate page (yellow image).
3. View the risk to health or safety on the opposing red page (see below left).
4. Fold out the red page to reveal the necessary control measures on the green page(s) (see below right).
5. Deliver the toolbox talk.



7.6.1 Explanation of the elements on each coloured page



COMMUNICATION WITH NON-ENGLISH SPEAKING WORKERS

7.7 Using the images

7.7.1 Site induction

The critical health, safety and welfare images are examples of a wider resource for use by site managers or supervisors. It is envisaged that the primary use will be during the induction training of foreign workers.

The images can also be used to support other forms of training (such as during the delivery of toolbox talks to foreign workers). However, they have their limitations as described later.

The images are intended to enhance the induction procedures for non/low-English speaking workers. However, in future it may be possible to import the images directly into existing induction presentations.

With careful forethought, this may enable foreign workers to be successfully inducted during the same presentation as other workers. If this approach is taken it is likely that additional effort will be required to confirm the retained level of understanding of the foreign workers, possibly including subsequent follow-up checks.

Existing induction training procedures for foreign workers who do not understand English may involve the use of an interpreter. However, problems can occur during translation and the use of the images may help to fill any gaps in worker understanding.

7.7.2 Site plans

Some of the images (such as those showing the location of welfare facilities, fire-fighting equipment and assembly points) lend themselves to being overlaid (physically or electronically) on site layout plans.

Depending on the size of the plans, it may be feasible for copies of the images to be electronically superimposed directly onto the plans in the appropriate location, or placed in the margin with arrows pointing to the actual location. These can be displayed during site inductions and kept in a suitable place for future reference.

7.7.3 Site inspections

The images can be used during site walkabout. For example, a worker not wearing essential personal protective equipment (PPE) can be informed using images starting with the number '5', which show items of PPE required on construction sites.

Furthermore, the images in the CITB database are presented in the sequence Hazard-Risk-Control(s) and can be used to educate the worker by showing them a hazard, which may be an unsafe act or condition, followed by the potential risk (consequences) and the necessary control(s).

Management controls are beyond the worker's direct authority but can be dealt with using an image containing a 'report to supervisor' message.

Workers can be tested for comprehension by asking them to consider whether an image is good or bad practice, or by showing the first sequence of images (hazard/risk) and asking the worker to identify the correct control image.

In addition, observation of workers after instruction has been given will confirm whether they have implemented the necessary controls/safe system of work.

7.7.4 Limitations of using pictorial images

Whilst pictorial images are useful aids for communicating health and safety information, they have their limitations. For example, some of the critical health, safety and welfare images contain some work that needs a permit to work. However, the rationale for introducing a particular type of permit or the procedures for obtaining one must be taught through detailed instruction, not easily covered solely by pictorial images.

Images should not be seen as a complete alternative to using interpreters but rather as tools to enhance existing practices; the law requires this should include interpreters, where appropriate.

CONTENTS

Behavioural safety



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GT700 Toolbox talks/supporting guidance documents

Toolbox talks on some of these topics are available in the GT700 publication. Supporting guidance documents covering some of these topics are available on our companion website.



Scan the QR code to complete a brief survey, and share your feedback on the course.

Overview

The chapter explores behavioural safety and the elements of working practice that can have an impact, both positive and negative, on this area. It offers information and models that can inform good practice in this significant area of focus for health and safety.

Studies have shown that up to 90% of accidents are attributable in some extent to human failure. Human factors are understandably an important focus for many accident investigations. The importance and relevance of these to preventing incidents, injuries, deaths and ill health within the workplace, as identified through case study research, therefore warrant the attention of all organisations, managers and employees.

8.1 Introduction

Promoting a behavioural safety culture is the responsibility of the whole organisation, including its supply chain, and this drives the way it operates on a daily basis.

There are rules, regulations, systems, procedures, codes of practice, standards and training requirements in place to support and govern health and safety in the workplace, but these can only be effective if there is a top-to-bottom and bottom-to-top culture of commitment to safe behaviour at all times.

Having good systems in place is not always enough. All individuals need to hold safety as a value, not just a priority. They need to demonstrate this commitment through their behaviour in taking responsibility for their own safety, as well as the safety of their co-workers and any other organisations or individuals that may be affected by the work they are undertaking.

The level of success is defined by how organisations 'live' their systems day-to-day – the behavioural culture of the organisation.

The HSE identifies behavioural safety as one important area within the overarching title of human factors that:



refer to environmental, organisational and job factors, and human and individual characteristics, which influence behaviour at work in a way which can affect health and safety.

Creating a culture of behavioural safety in any organisation provides a focus for understanding and influencing the way managers and individuals act in relation to work and decision making. It is based on the following process.

- Identifying and making evident safe and unsafe practices.
- Observing and intervening, where appropriate, to encourage safe practice or to amend unsafe practice.
- Feeding back vital information to inform decision making.
- Training, process, material and environmental change, as appropriate.
- Recognising safe working practices and supporting good practices.

Behavioural safety represents a proactive rather than a reactive process, engaging all managers and workers within a culture of continuous improvement and safety awareness.

For this reason, communication at and across all levels of an organisation is vital to the development of a successful and influential strategy.



Useful HSE publications are available from the HSE website.

A significant factor in reducing the number of accidents is to raise awareness, at all organisational levels and within the supply chain, to ensure that behavioural safety change is part of the culture.

8.2 Important points

- Historically, improvements in health and safety standards have been achieved through **engineering technology/controls** (plant and equipment) and **safety management systems** (risk assessments, permits to work and so on).
- These improvements will not fully eradicate incidents and accidents.
- Understanding how people make decisions and **why people act** as a consequence is the vital third element.
- The biggest gain in improving health and safety performance comes from integrating and understanding the human element of risk management.
- Companies that incorporate behavioural safety programmes into the day-to-day running of their business see dramatic drops in accident rates.

- In order for a behavioural safety approach to work, consistently high standards of engineering technology/controls and safety management systems need to be established.
- Behavioural safety is not a quick-win initiative – it takes time and commitment from all levels of a company or organisation. It is not an alternative to applying sound, basic principles of health and safety management.
- Effective leadership, management and workforce support is crucial for the success of any programme.
- People may generally think they are working safely, or that the risk of something happening is minimal, due to their knowledge and past experience. Those observing can often see that the risk is greater than first thought and thus intervention techniques play an important role in developing a positive safety culture.
- Workers respond more positively to co-worker/peer intervention.
- Worker engagement is a fundamental component of any behavioural safety programme.

8.3 Reasons for using a behavioural safety approach

Over recent years, significant improvements have been achieved in health, safety and environmental performance. These have been gained largely through technological advances and improved focus through the use of management controls and systems.

However, this successful downward trend is levelling off.

Increased focus on human elements associated with health and safety practice, awareness, commitment and decision-making in the form of a behavioural safety approach will contribute to more improvements over time in construction and other industries.

Evidence and support for this has come from HSE case study investigations and research into major reportable accidents.

The case studies identify actions and strategies that have been implemented within the example organisations in order to improve specific health and safety practice.

From this work, the HSE and contributing partners have identified a list of human factors. These include the following.

- Introducing human factors.
- Competence.
- Humans and risk (integration of human factors into risk assessments and accident investigation).
- Written procedures.
- Emergency response.
- Maintenance.
- Safety culture.

The HSE also notes other problems (such as those listed below) found from inspection and assessment.

- Too much emphasis being placed on reducing personal accidents (slips, trips and falls), without an equal focus on preventing major accidents.
- Failing to realise that safety culture is about everyone in the organisation, including managers, employees and the supply chain.
- Not being clear about how the safety management system will prevent or reduce human errors, which may lead to major accidents.

To be effective, a behaviour-based approach to health and safety requires the following.

- Commitment and a proactive approach from the senior management team to improving behavioural safety. This commitment should be demonstrated by how they fund, lead and support it.
- Effective, open top-down and bottom-up communication and engagement on all aspects of safety in the workplace and the ability to influence and implement good practice.
- A procedure for individuals or groups, including the supply chain, to raise issues or concerns to inform decision making and take remedial action without fear.
- A focus on people, often incorporating formal and informal one-to-one or group observations of workers performing work tasks. This includes setting goals carefully and giving timely feedback on safety-related behaviour through coaching and mentoring.
- Recognition of good practice and sharing it at all levels.
- Creation of a learning culture for people to continuously improve through formal and informal training, coaching and mentoring.
- An effective response and solution to unsafe behaviour, incidents and near-misses.



Commitment by the team is vital

- Safety critical communications.
- Alarm handling and control room design.
- Fatigue.
- Organisational change and transition management.
- Human factors and the major accident prevention policy (MAPP).

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- Transparent and fair leadership.
- Awareness amongst individuals or groups, including the supply chain, of different ways to consider or query human factors – how we do what we do and why.
- Solid principles about engaging, motivating, assisting, reinforcing and sustaining safe behaviours.
- A systematic approach, examining the motivation and underlying behaviours, in order to increase safe behaviour.
- Continuous rather than a one-off approach to deliver sustainable and positive results.
- Allowing time to achieve measurable results. However, results can be achieved immediately through observation and action where appropriate.
- Emphasising an increase in safe behaviours rather than focusing on length of time without injury.
- A proactive, preventative approach as well as learning from incidents.
- Integration with existing practices.

 For a human factors checklist visit the HSE website.

8.4 Preparing to implement a behavioural approach

The HSE's core guidance defines human factors as the interaction between three main areas affecting human performance at work.

These consist of the following.

- The job.
- The individual.
- The organisation.



8.4.1 The job

Tasks should be designed in accordance with ergonomic principles to take into account limitations in human performance. Matching the job to the person will ensure that they are not overloaded and that the most effective contribution to the business results.

Physical match includes the design of the whole workplace and working environment. Mental match involves the individual's information and decision-making requirements, as well as their perception of the tasks.

Mismatches between job requirements and workers' capabilities create the potential for human error.

Job design will have a focus on the following.

- Areas of work and the environment in which it is carried out.
- Materials and tools.
- Control and display panels and devices.
- Communication and management systems.
- All job-related written guidance and information.

8.4.2 The individual

People bring to a job their attitudes, skills, habits and personality, which can be strengths or weaknesses depending on the demands of the task. Individual characteristics influence behaviour in complex and significant ways. Their effects on task performance may be negative and may not always be mitigated by job design. Some characteristics, such as personality, are fixed and cannot be changed. Others, such as skills and attitudes, may be changed or enhanced. Personnel selection policies and procedures to select appropriate individuals for the job specifications should consider the following:

- age, physique and capabilities matched to job requirements
- aptitude, intelligence and personality
- competence (the right skills, knowledge, experience and training)
- fitness for work and health surveillance, where this is needed
- the needs of special groups of employees
- monitoring of personal performance on safety for safety critical staff.

8.4.3 The organisation

Organisational factors have a major influence on individuals and group behaviour, yet it is not uncommon for this to be overlooked during the design of work and in the investigation of accidents and incidents. Organisations need to establish their own positive health and safety culture. The climate needs to promote employee involvement and commitment at all levels, emphasising that deviation from established safety standards is not acceptable.

The organisation will ensure that it supports managers to:

- take responsibility for all aspects of work and work design
- devise and maintain a good safety management system
- encourage a good safety culture by showing commitment
- consult the workforce on important decisions
- commit to learning from the latest thinking on good practice in safety
- openly encourage identification and shared learning from accidents and near misses.

Together, these areas constitute the solid foundations on which behavioural safety programmes can be addressed and developed.



Good practice and case studies indicate that prior to commencing any behavioural safety change programme, intervention, factors relating to the job, the individual and the organisation will all need to be considered.

Before sites embark on a behavioural safety programme, it is recommended that the following preparation has taken place.

- All hazards have been identified.
- Human performance issues have been identified and managed (particularly in relation to safety critical roles and activities).
- The hierarchy of control has been applied to prevent the occurrence of identified hazards/minimise their consequences should they occur.
- The site has the required engineering, operating and maintenance capability and experience (including appropriate staffing levels).
- Accurate operating procedures are available for all eventualities, including emergencies.
- Individuals (operators) are fully prepared to deal with all conditions. This will include identification of training needs, training, assessment, rehearsal and reassessment.
- Training should include underlying knowledge of the process, so that operators can troubleshoot (identify and respond to abnormal situations as they develop). It should not just provide the minimum knowledge required to operate the plant. This approach will help to manage residual risk arising from hazards that were not identified or effectively addressed.
- Lessons have been learnt from site, company and industry experience.
- Succession planning ensures that corporate knowledge is retained.
- Safety management arrangements and risk control measures have been reviewed to ensure that they remain usable and relevant.

It is recommended that only when these technical and systems issues have been addressed can the timing and appropriateness of a behavioural programme be addressed. The guidance also goes on to highlight the following for consideration.

- Do not underestimate the resources required – it is not a one-off exercise, but a new way of working that must be maintained for any positive results to be sustained.
- Do not be over-optimistic – not all interventions are completely successful in their main aim. High expectations may lead to disappointment later.
- Be clear about what you want to achieve and how you will know that you have achieved it.
- Pilot the intervention (for example, to ensure that the approach is workable, that the facilitators or observers understand what is required and that the appropriate data is being recorded).
- Talk to similar companies and trade associations about their interventions and experiences.
- As with all interventions, listen to employees and use the process to improve dialogue – involve them early in the choice of programme.
- Make the language and style of the package your own, as off-the-shelf packages may not be appropriate for your site's needs.
- Use strong site facilitators – the success of such interventions is greatly helped by using personable, experienced and respected site personnel as facilitators.
- Ensure that the focus is on the root causes of behaviours.
- On major hazard sites, don't neglect process safety. Beware of 'what gets measured gets done' – that is, while regular measurement and reporting keeps you focused on improvement, placing too much emphasis on reducing personal accidents (such as slips, trips and falls) could mean neglecting the prevention of major accidents.

8.5 Factors influencing a behavioural approach

The practicalities involved in successfully implementing a behavioural approach to health and safety are listed below and overleaf.

- Preparation – knowing what you are doing and why.
- Establishing an effective system of two-way communication to develop mutual trust between management and workers.
- Engaging the right people in the decision making.
- Observing people at work.
- Assessing safe and unsafe behaviours (being non-judgemental).
- Making timely and appropriate interventions.
- Establishing why unsafe behaviours take place.

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- Influencing those behaving unsafely not to do so in the future.
- Recognising safe behaviour and, if appropriate, rewarding it.
- Continuing assessment and research whilst looking for improvements in safe behaviour.

The overall and wider benefits to this implementation can include the following.

- More effective communication regarding safety between management and frontline workers.
- Greater management visibility and engagement.
- Increased efficiency.
- Greater flexibility and effectiveness of workers.
- A reduction in the number of workplace injuries.
- Improvement in the standards of health and safety.
- Reduced physical and financial losses for the individual and the employer.
- The extension of safe working practices into home life.

The following elements, on the pages following this one, are all factors that are relevant and require consideration when implementing a behavioural safety programme.

8.5.1 Psychology of behaviour

Behavioural safety applies tried and tested psychological principles in order to mediate the way people and organisations do things, particularly how people act or behave in respect of their own health and safety and that of others. Among many other factors, the behavioural approach takes into account how people think, act, behave and respond to certain situations. It also considers how people's immediate surroundings can influence their thoughts and actions.

8.5.1.1 Thought processes

Contrary to previous belief, the conscious or alert state of mind can only be actively engaged in one activity or thought process at any one time. Neuroscience research has identified that distractions from a single task can, at best, result in less efficient working and, at worst, can contribute to a stress response. This is particularly so if someone tries to finish a task but cannot complete it as time goes on.

The human brain is strongly programmed to avoid perceived threats and generally (but less strongly) programmed for reward from tasks achieved. This latter results in the small, so-called 'dopamine spike', which drives us to continue with reward-based behaviour. In practical terms, if a distraction disturbs a person's thought processes or task, they may, for example, trip over a toolbox they have placed on some steps or fall into a hole they have recently dug. Other thoughts have entered their conscious mind and the hazard is momentarily forgotten.

At the most basic level, good workplace practice (such as avoiding distractions and removing hazards immediately) can support the wider behavioural safety programme. Often the ability to increase safety awareness by the individual doing a mental risk assessment (that is, asking 'What is going to put me at risk while I do this job?') is not improved or encouraged once relevant training has been undertaken. Practising this type of self-awareness has safety benefits, especially if it is recorded.

People at work benefit from being able to discuss and take responsibility for the day-to-day aspects of their job and from feeling competent to do so. The human side of the working environment is a highly significant factor in determining the success of a behavioural safety environment and this warrants a focus on management training and commitment. By helping people understand the implications of how they work and engaging their knowledge, we can identify the process that integrates human factors into the core management system of the business. Effort should be targeted at encouraging positive, open and real communication that resolves issues when they arise, rather than keeping them hidden until an incident occurs.

8.5.1.2 Habitual behaviours

Habits are subconscious ways of thinking, both positive and negative. They are formed when a task or behaviour is repeated over time. This enables the thinking part of the brain (the pre-frontal cortex) to conserve energy through reducing its need for active attention and processing. Effectively, the brain is saying 'I have done this before – no need to pay conscious attention to this then!'

The more repetitions an action has, the stronger the habit, until very little, if any, conscious thought is given to the task. This is termed being *unconsciously competent*, and an example would be driving a car after much experience. An example of a habit that can have negative consequences is not wearing eye protection when using a disc cutter because the past is used to justify present actions. The worker has not been injured before so argues that they will not be injured now. Similar arguments are often put forward to dismiss many self-protective and safety-focused equipment and practices.

Similarly, a positive habit can be formed by communicating the benefits and consciously ensuring that eye protection is worn. This could be achieved through raising awareness via posters or stickers on the disc cutter, ensuring suitable eye protection is available with the disc cutter, or spoken reminders from work colleagues and managers. When encouraged and reinforced, through these or similar measures, wearing eye protection becomes a comfortable habit and the expected norm.

8.5.1.3 Values, beliefs, expectations, attitudes and behaviour

We all have our own values and beliefs (attitudes) that underlie how we think, and which then drive the way we act and behave. Being able to influence these is a significant management responsibility, which can be achieved through day-to-day working practice, the level and manner of communication and the delivery of any structured programme to address health and safety interventions.

Whilst the commitment of managers can send a powerful positive message regarding behavioural culture, a lack of commitment can be equally but negatively powerful. Case studies suggest that low expectations and poor leadership from management can create negative attitudes and a lack of trust from employees. This in turn can result in poor methods of working resulting in poor health and safety performance.

8.5.2 The challenge

Some **potential barriers to progress** that have been identified from existing behavioural safety programmes are shown below.

- Management promoting a negative or passive message, making the workforce believe that it is collecting unnecessary data or that the information will never provide solutions.
- Overreliance on off the shelf solutions and thereby not fully owning the ongoing development of the programme.
- Middle managers either excluded from communication or not understanding the programme.
- Processes not reaching their potential because they are time-consuming and seen as stopping people from getting on with the job without consideration of the huge potential benefits.
- Processes that generate committees, create databases and induce an overload that the majority of small and medium businesses find difficult to resource.
- Organisations fully understanding that behavioural safety approaches are not short-term solutions but may be 'a change in the way we do things round here' that will need an effective investment of time, resources and commitment.
- A lack of trust leading workers to feel that they will be blamed in some way.
- An existing environment of poor industrial relationships or grievance procedures.

Some **enablers to progress** are shown below.

- Commitment of executives, directors and management to the programme implementation.
- Middle managers' involvement in, and understanding of, the behavioural safety programme objectives.
- Sufficient resources at all levels with which to support work, materials and training.
- A good level of trust between managers and frontline workers.
- The absence of industrial relations issues.
- Existing workforce involvement in health and safety practice.
- Innovative and new practice features to the programme on a regular (for example, annual) basis.

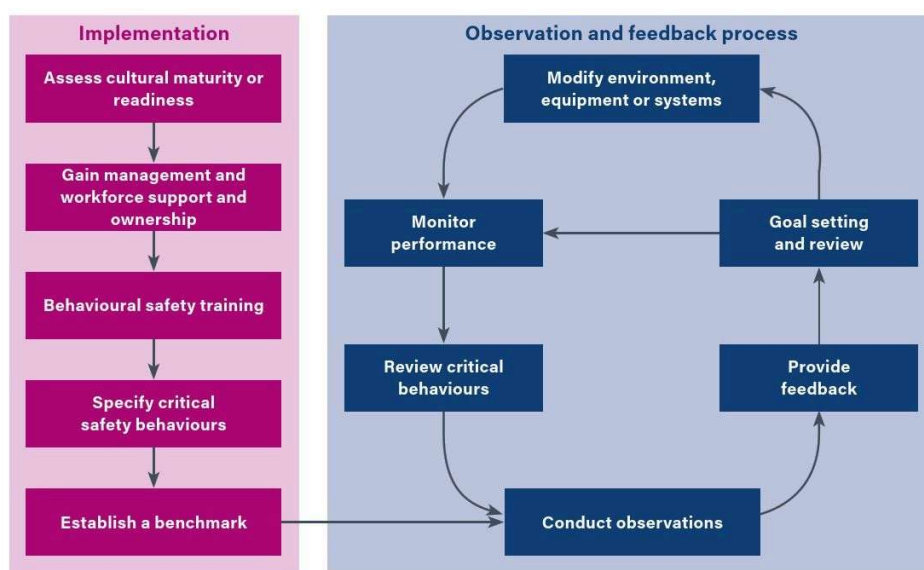


Induction for all: enabling progress on a behavioural safety programme

8.6 Key stages in a behavioural safety programme

Following research, the Keil Centre* produced a report for the HSE, *Strategies to promote safe behaviour as part of a health and safety management system*. This offers the following model of how programmes may be implemented within organisations. Not all elements need to be included in all programmes; this is for guidance and adaptation as appropriate.

* The Keil Centre is a company of chartered psychologists and registered ergonomists offering professional services to industry, government and private individuals.



Overview of a behavioural safety programme

BEHAVIOURAL SAFETY



For further information on behavioural safety, visit the HSE website.



Recognising the importance of management commitment to a behavioural safety programme is vital to determine the successful implementation of that programme.

8.6.1 Implementation

8.6.1.1 Assess cultural maturity or readiness

At this first stage, the organisation would assess whether it is ready to commit to the implementation of a behavioural safety programme. This is the stage where potential challenges to success are identified and addressed. This could include an organisational restructure or relocation.

It could also highlight and benchmark management commitment and communication processes, by holding workshops, issuing questionnaires or simply through one-to-one interviews.

8.6.1.2 Management and workforce support and ownership

Management and workforce support is crucial for the success of the programme. It defines the culture within which the behavioural safety work occurs and can be encouraged through early involvement of all individuals.

Involvement is generally an emotional response and depends on both the commitment of the individual and the organisation's support and appreciation of their input, views and opinions. People will need to see that they carry influence and can positively transform the style and content of the programme to be implemented.

Success of the programme will also depend on the opportunities for individuals involved in managing the programme, or in acting as behavioural safety champions. Not everyone can fulfil these roles and so the organisation may create a process for recruiting employees to a steering group or to co-ordinator roles. Volunteers can be requested and consideration given to representatives from the entire workforce



Many programmes require that observations are made of colleagues carrying out tasks. These observations are generally carried out by frontline workers and identify issues relevant to behavioural safety practice and the overall programme. Training is required for these observers to record information, deliver feedback and focus on the objectives that are critical for continuous improvement.

8.6.1.3 Behavioural safety training

Training managers and workers to understand behavioural safety tools and objectives is crucial to programme success. At the most basic level, this can be awareness training, whilst co-ordinators, managers and those carrying out the main responsibilities will require more comprehensive information and training. Some programmes train all staff, whereas others train a minority of employees. Decisions regarding who to train are taken on the basis of internal knowledge and resources (people, financial and material) and the depth of the programme itself.

8.6.1.4 Specify critical safety behaviours

Behavioural safety programmes focus on developing a checklist of critical safety behaviours that is completed by the trained observers. Critical health and safety behaviours are identified through a number of different means. These include, but are not solely based on, the analysis of previous accident and incident reports. Additional information can be gained from other sources.

These can include reviewing previous risk assessments (such as control of substances hazardous to health (COSHH)) and audits, in addition to formal and informal input from frontline staff and managers. Near-miss or dangerous occurrence reports are equally valid sources of critical safety behaviours. Preparation that focuses solely on formal reporting is important but limited in scope. This will exclude critically unsafe behaviours that have not yet resulted in serious consequences but which hide latent risk. It is vital that critical safety behaviours and their measures are sufficiently well defined to enable meaningful observations to be made and recorded.



Formal and informal reporting are significant areas of research when defining the critical safety behaviours to be addressed by the programme. Important contributions to this process can be made from a number of levels within an organisation.

8.6.1.5 Establish a benchmark

The final preparatory element involves identifying a baseline, or benchmarking the organisation's current situation, in relation to the selected critical safety behaviours. This is established through conducting observations of these areas in practice.

A benchmark will enable review and evaluation of the programme's effectiveness to be more clearly defined.

8.6.2 Continuous process of observation and feedback

After the implementation phase, this next continuous stage of observation, feedback, goal setting and review commences.

8.6.2.1 Conduct observations

The next stage in the process is conducting observations. This is generally peer-to-peer, but can be done by managers. It is usual for the observer to be provided with a checklist (the critical behaviours identified previously). The observer indicates on the list whether the individual is safe, unsafe or if the behaviour was not observed.



Defining critical safety behaviours clearly at the pre-observation stage and through the benchmarking process will increase quality and meaning during the programme.

8.6.2.2 Provide feedback

The provision of feedback is an imperative process within the behavioural safety programme, which can survive or flounder depending on the skills of observers, their style and credibility. For this reason, feedback must be considered a critical skill and individuals should be trained accordingly. It most effectively reinforces safe behaviour when it is positive and delivered by someone perceived as credible and knowledgeable by the individual receiving the feedback. Feedback can have a greater or lesser impact depending on the following factors.

- When it is delivered (generally, the closer and more relevant to the observation, the more meaningful the feedback).
- The focus of the feedback (this should be on the observed behaviour, not on the individual practising the behaviour).
- Relevance (the feedback should fit the expectations of the person receiving the feedback and with the behaviour under observation).

There are two main types of feedback.

1. **Summative feedback** offers more general comment on an individual's overall performance.
2. **Formative feedback** provides more detailed information on how they might improve their performance in the future.



The quality of feedback and its style of delivery is critical to the success of a behavioural safety programme. Observers will need to be trained in positive feedback skills in order to contribute as effectively as possible to the behaviour improvement cycle.

8.6.2.3 Goal setting and review

Goals are crucial to any system of managing performance as they can have an important influence in terms of encouraging and supporting behavioural change.

- They describe the desired result.
- They give a sense of direction and purpose.
- They provide a yardstick for assessment.
- They enable people to prioritise.
- They link activities to the overall direction of the organisation.

Goals describe something to be accomplished by individuals, teams and organisations over a period of time. They can be expressed as targets to be met, such as tasks to be completed, or changes in behaviour by specified dates. Goals need to be defined and agreed. They will relate to the overall purpose of the job and define performance areas – all the aspects of the job that contribute to achieving its overall purpose.

Defining goals

- Agreeing the job aim establishes **why** a job is done.
- Identifying key result areas or criteria establishes **what** has to be done.
- Setting goals establishes **what** specifically has to be done.
- Setting measurable goals identifies the **degree** to which something has to be done and by **when**.
- Agreeing actions shows **how** measurable goals are to be achieved.

Skilful goal setting focuses attention on the important targets to be achieved. They enable the cascading of the organisation's objectives to individual level so that everyone, at every level, is aware of how they contribute to teams, divisions and the organisation as a whole. Goals need to be **SMART**.

Specific – unambiguous, concrete. Teams and individuals know exactly what is expected of them.

Measurable – quantified either by a statistical result or a behaviour that can be observed.

Achievable – stretching and challenging but not impossible.

Realistic – linked to the individual and to the team's and organisation's business plans.

Timely – include agreed completion dates.

Goal setting is a participative process involving the observer and either the individual or group concerned.

8.6.2.4 Monitor performance

Behavioural safety programmes are monitored over time and focused on measuring the impact of the programme on the initially identified critical safety behaviours. A good measure of success is an improved percentage of observations where behaviour is observed as safe. If there is little or no change in this measure over time for some or all observations, it will be important to review the specific behaviours with regard to barriers to change. The factors that work against safe behavioural practice could be related to people or to product or design.